A Commentary on the Difficult Points called The Lamp of Glorious Innate Joy

Śrīsahajānandapradīpa-nāma-pañcikā · Toh 1202 · Derge Tengyur
དཔལ་ལྷན་ཅིག་སྐྱེས་པའི་དགའ་བའི་སྒྲོན་མ་ཞེས་བྱ་བའི་དཀའ་འགྲེལ།

A Commentary on the Difficult Points called The Lamp of Glorious Innate Joy, in Sanskrit Śrī Sahajānandapradīpa nāma Pañcikā and in Tibetan Dpal lhan cig skyes pa'i dga' ba'i sgron ma zhes bya ba'i dka' 'grel, is Toh 1202 in the Tengyur, where it belongs among the commentaries on the tantras. Opening with homage to the glorious Jñānatilaka, it works chapter by chapter through the difficult points of a tantra connected with that deity, distinguishing provisional from definitive meaning and explaining the four joys, the empowerments, the channels and wheels of the subtle body, the inner fire and the descending drop, the grounds of realization, and above all innate or intrinsic joy as the ineffable union of wisdom and method. Its colophon attributes it to the great master Vajraguhya and records that it was translated and explained by the Indian preceptor, the great yogin Prajñāgupta.

In the language of India: śrī sahaja ānanda pradīpaṃ nāma pañcikā. In the language of Tibet: A Commentary on the Difficult Points, called The Lamp of Glorious Innate Joy.

Homage to glorious Jñānatilaka (Drop of Gnosis).

Wisdom, nirvāṇa, the special joy, the sky;
Gnosis, saṃsāra, the supreme joy, the going:
This nondual lord of the jewel-stealing ladies
I have set forth for my own recollection, for the good of disciples, and so on.

The meaning of the passage beginning "Thus did I" is applied at length as the meaning of the four syllables, and it is divided into the provisional meaning and the definitive meaning. This is taught as follows:

The essence that is the lord
Of the five, Buddhaḍāka and the rest,
Is called Vajrasattva;
That is held to be the essence.
What this tantra, from its head to its foot,
Expresses, its meaning and its qualities,
Is therefore Vajrasattva.

And because it is connected, it is tantra.
From the single family of a alone,
The letters of the families branch out into many,
And in the same way they gather back into one.
This is the analogy that fits the tantra.
In the single taste, the intrinsic nature of the meaning,
Wisdom and means are divided into two;
And from their division two by two,
Each one, too, is divided, split into five apiece.

The aim, the extent, and so forth are not explained, since they are easy to understand.

As for "Thus" and the rest, it is evaṃ. e is the triangle, the source of phenomena (dharmodaya), whose intrinsic nature is wisdom. vaṃ is the circle, whose intrinsic nature is the gnosis of means; and this is applied at length. Accordingly it is said:

The beautiful form of e
Is adorned in its center with vaṃ.

"Thus did I hear at one time: the Blessed One," and so on, are the excellences, the tantra and the rest. They are taught as follows: the tantra; the compiler, the Lord of Gods; the time, which is free from past time and the like, that is, a time that cannot be apprehended; the Teacher, the Blessed One himself; the retinue, seventy-two koṭis of heroes, heroines, and others; and the place, the source of phenomena, the sky-expanse of the Blessed Lady, the Perfection of Wisdom, and so on.

Alternatively, "Thus did I" is explained as the wheel of great bliss, the wheel of enjoyment, the wheel of Dharma, the wheel of emanation, and so on; or as the goddesses of the four elements, Buddhalocanā and the others, and so on. "Heard" means heard by me myself, not as if passed along from one person to the next. "At one time": when everything, out to the wheel of emanation at the extreme end, becomes one there, in the abode of Vajrasattva, that is to be understood as the utmost time.

"Blessed One" means one who has conquered the māras of the four wheels and so on, that is, who has destroyed them and the like: the essence endowed with the gnosis and qualities of the six joys. "Tathāgata," thus-gone, means that just as those before have gone, so the channels, once completely purified,

have gone, and therefore abide as gods and goddesses. "All" means all the former aspects of the channels and so on, without exception. "Body, speech, and mind" are the three, the wheel of great bliss and the others, that is, the wheels of the three families. "Vajra" is the wheel of emanation, that is, the navel, or else the heart. "Heroes" are the sixteen channels on the right of the wheel of great bliss, or else the channels of means. The "heroines" are the channels on the left of great bliss and the purity of the wheel of enjoyment, or else the left-hand channels of wisdom. "Surrounded" means surrounded by all of these: the ḍākinīs and the rest. "Lady" means a woman, the wisdom consort, such as the action seal (karmamudrā). In her abode he dwells at all times. Alternatively, the heroes and the rest are to be understood by distinguishing bodhicitta as seminal fluid and as bliss.

There, the words from "glorious Stainless Sky and" up to "Sky Face" set out the names of the sixteen heroes; then the words from "the sovereign lady of the heroines, Lāmā," up to "is the Mother," and again from "of Marata" up to "is Desire-Form Lady," set out the names of the heroines. "Such excellent faces," and so on, teaches their shapes and colors, such as the color of their bodies; since this is taught below, it is not taught here. The words "seventy-two koṭis of ladies of the mātṛkās" (the mother goddesses) are likewise to be understood as explained before. "In the center" means in the center of all those wheels. "The union of great, excellent delight" means the bliss that arises from the play of uniting the two, wisdom and means.

"The Blessed One" means that he himself called the compiler and spoke. If one asks why: because the Lord of Gods had not understood the meaning of glorious Jñānatilaka, he called him and spoke. So that the Lord of Gods might grasp and understand what he had not comprehended, the meaning of "Thus did I hear at one time" and the rest, he called the bodhisattva mahāsattva Lord of Gods and, from the words "O Lord of Gods" onward, spoke, dividing it into three, suchness and the rest. Now, "bodhi," awakening, is nonconceptual gnosis. To contemplate it with a one-pointed mind is "sattva." Once that is spontaneously accomplished in oneself, to act for the benefit of sentient beings is "sattva" once again. "Mahā," great, means being able to accomplish the benefit of sentient beings. As it is said:

Whatever gnosis has abandoned apprehended and apprehender,
That is the bodhisattva:
Vajrapāṇi and the others.
That is the mahāsattva.

The Lord of Gods, too, is such a one. "To the Blessed One who had spoken thus" refers to the Teacher himself, glorious Jñānatilaka. "Lord of Gods" is a name: it means the sovereign of all the gods, one equal to the Blessed One. "The entire retinue" means the ḍākinīs of the seventy-two classes and so on. "Together" means that the Lord of Gods and the entire retinue performed the circumambulation at one and the same time, and after it the prostration and so on.

Alternatively, the Blessed One is the bodhicitta of great bliss. "The Lord of Gods" and the rest means being surrounded by a retinue of seventy-two koṭis of channels and so on. "Three times" means circling the wheel of enjoyment three times, to the right. "Bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet" means that as soon as the bodhicitta of the wheel of great bliss came to rest on the seat of the vajra feet, in the jewel palace, the entire retinue paid homage. As scripture says:

The profound gnosis is realized by oneself.
That vajra is in the center of the jewel.
Nonconceptual great bliss is at the extreme.
Clearly realizing this is homage.

Also, in the Five Stages (Pañcakrama) composed by the great master Nāgārjuna:

To see clearly, by oneself, one's own gnosis:
That, here, is homage.

The master Śākyamitra said this. By implication, this is to be understood as the homage paid as soon as the Blessed One was seated on the vajra seat (vajrāsana).

"Gazing at the ground" means that he remained gazing at the ground because he could not manage a reply. "Without saying anything" means that he stayed silent because joy, the ultimate nature, is beyond all such phenomena as being put into words. "At that time" and so on refers to the time of the homage. "In the sky" is explained as "in the empty atmosphere." "Mandārava" means an offering of many emanated things: flowers of every kind, jewels, and so on. Alternatively, the "sky" is the space of the channels of the wheel of great bliss and the others. "Great mandārava" and the rest are to be applied, in their order, to the ten winds and so on, in the place that is the empty space of the channels. "Endowed with great fragrance and flowers" means that

bodhicitta, endowed with the fragrance of bliss and with those winds, descends from the sky. And where it says that they fell at the feet, this is to be understood as the feet of the Blessed One.

"Again the Blessed One called" and so on means that, since there had been no reply before and amazement had arisen at that, he afterward called the Lord of Gods once more. "The Lord of Gods made a request" means that he made his request to the Blessed One. This is taught as follows. "Blessed One, the three suchnesses" and so on means: "Is there not even an expression of signs, entities, and the like?" "At this I am amazed" means that amazement arose because what is without signs, entities, and the like had been spoken of as entities such as signs. "How wonderful!" means astonishing and marvelous. "Hero" means one whose very nature is to vanquish all the vicious and the rest. "Great" is said of one who acts for the benefit of sentient beings and is adorned with the qualities of a buddha's greatness. "Lord of Gods": the Blessed One called him by name, as one possessed of all the meanings given before. "By the holder of the supreme vajra": he holds, without distraction, the state of that vajra body, the indivisible body which is the supreme buddha-nature (tathāgatagarbha), and "by" expresses that he is the agent. "Spoke this" is explained as referring to what comes below.

This is taught as follows. "The three suchnesses" is intended as the three, e, vaṃ, and mā. The words from "of the self" up to "measure," and "Is there not?", are explained as ya and so on. And this is to be understood through the words from "Thus" up to "the Blessed One." If one asks, "Then why does he not speak of the Tathāgata and the rest?": the retinue, the Tathāgata and the rest, are gathered there, and by realizing the meaning of suchness and the rest, all comes to be realized.

Accordingly it says, "Bodhisattva Lord of Gods, you are right." "All phenomena" are conditioned and unconditioned phenomena, that is, the phenomena included under the outer and the inner. "O" means singling him out from his companions. "Whose nature is emptiness" means that conditioned phenomena and the rest are empty of essential nature: this is ultimate truth. "How can this be known?" means that a meaning free of conventional terms cannot be known as something expressed or understood; therefore he asks, "How can it be known?" It is to be known by relying on a cause and support that is a mere mirage: relative truth, which appears as a mere illusion or mirage. "All phenomena" are the phenomena spoken of before: the support and the supported. "Just as" shows that the meaning is to be understood through a

fitting example. He says, "If, for the fragrance that depends on musk, there were no musk as a substance, how could the fragrance be found?" That is, in the example, without relying on musk, a solid substance, the empty fragrance, which is no substance, is not found. The meaning is that, in the same way, without relying on relative truth, which is mere illusion, ultimate truth is not found. As scripture says:

Relying on the generated body,
One purifies the habitual tendencies of the ordinary.
That, too, is one's own suchness:
To know oneself is the body of great bliss.

"Likewise" teaches that, as with musk and the rest, one must rely on the relative. "By its own essence, by place and by measure, and of form" means that without relying on relative bodhicitta, ultimate bodhicitta is not found. It is like looking for fish where there is no water.

The three suchnesses are the three: vajra body, vajra speech, and vajra mind. "Self" means realizing the meaning of these three without error. "Moon Saṃvara" means that what was explained before under "heard" is to be understood as the five aggregates, the sense sources, the elements, and so on, whose nature is the buddhas and so on. "The body of the Great Seal (mahāmudrā)" is the very being of the vajra essence, which abides naturally within oneself as the nature of the gnosis being. Alternatively, the three suchnesses are the three: the wheel of wind, that of fire, and the wheel of emanation. Moon Saṃvara is the wheel of enjoyment, the wheel of the Great Seal; and the wheel of Dharma is applied to everything in general. Again, "suchness" and so on are taught as the rain and so on: relying on these, one comes to find the ultimate. Through what is empty it is not so. Moreover, through causing, arising, support, and abiding, the meaning of joy and the rest comes about.

Alternatively, "the three suchnesses" and so on: at the time of the union of means and wisdom, once the place of the bird-face has been sought, the hare-marked one (the moon) rests as a single drop at the mouth of the jewel, at the jewel's tip; it passes on to the bird-face; and it is clear in the nondual interval. This is the instruction of Vajrabodhi. These three are explained as mind, mental factors, and ignorance.

"Therefore" teaches the sense "to be drawn out from this and that." This is explained as follows:

Distinguished as pervaded and pervader,
It is the great bliss of nonduality.

This teaches that great bliss arises naturally from the two, ultimate bodhicitta and relative bodhicitta. "All" means the phenomena of the world and those beyond the world. "Dual" is explained as dividing things into what abides separately. "Non-" means that the phenomena that appear as two are one in a state of indivisibility. "Reality": the indivisible is what is called reality.

Accordingly it is said:

Means and wisdom are distinct
As the essence of support and supported;
These two are equal, in the sense of being one.
What realizes this is nondual reality.

And further:

The accomplishment ascertained as indivisible
Is the nature of the Great Seal.

If one asks why: there is no contradiction in its being the nature of the Great Seal, for natural joy is what is called the Great Seal. Nothing else is so. Natural joy, moreover, cannot be touched by any joy. As the Hevajra Tantra says:

The innate is untouched by anything else.
What is found, set apart from the three,
Is the nature of the three, yet free of the three.
That is untouched: it is the innate.

Therefore natural joy and the Great Seal are not to be divided as distinct.

"The bliss of the six" is the six families, Vairocana and the rest, together with their wisdom consorts. "Supreme gnosis" is the nondual gnosis that arises from the union of the two, father and mother. "The body of bliss arises from the two" means that genuine gnosis arises by way of the two, means and wisdom, the relative and the ultimate bodies. "It dwells in the center of the six wheels" refers to Vajrasattva, who acts as lord of the six great maṇḍalas. "The three suchnesses" and so on are explained as the three families, vajra body and the rest. Alternatively, the meaning of "The bliss of the six, supreme gnosis," and so on is applied to the sixth wheel, adorned with bodhicitta within the empty opening of the lotus, and so on. Alternatively, the words from "six" up to "known as the cause" are said with reference to applying one gnosis of bliss to each of these: the rain, the drop, the mode, the mere mode, the

supreme, and the other supreme. It is the result of nonduality. Since the two are the cause, it says, "known as the cause."

"In the body, the support, on the staff of life,
The gnosis of the six unions dwells,"

and so on: the staff of life is the place of the six unions mentioned before, the rain and the rest, together with their gnosis. Alternatively, "the body" is relative bodhicitta. "The support" is ultimate bodhicitta. "The staff of life" is bodhicitta endowed with the life wind, and the wind of exertion and so on. "Through the six unions gnosis dwells" and so on: from the ultimate and the relative, this is applied to the stages of gnosis. That is, when the winds, the life wind and the rest, have ceased, the unions of the gnosis of joy above and below are the sixteen, the six, the four, and so on. And again, three are complete: in those three, the three natures are complete.

"The place at the hub of the six wheels": the hub of the six, the wheel of great bliss and the rest, is the very being of the staff of life. Its interior is called "the center." "Subtle, embodied, the excellent are six" refers to the six knots of the channels. They are subtle because beginners do not realize them; when they are realized through familiarization again and again, they are known as the very being of the deities, and they also appear in actuality. The body of these six channels is endowed with bodhicitta. "The yoga together with drops" is said of the drop that is the very substance of gnosis. If one asks how: it is like oil pervading a white mustard seed. And with respect to the channels, drops, winds, and so on, that nature of bodhicitta is applied to the stages of joy. "Within the staff of life" means that these dwell at ease within the life channel, not within the outer petals and so on. It is at the hub of the wheel of great bliss, because there, in the place of bliss, the Blessed One dwells on the relative level like the moon in water. He does not dwell in the branches, the kumuda lilies, and so on, but only at the hub of the channels.

"The companion endowed with life" is the gnosis endowed with the channels, the drops, the life wind, and so on. "That" shows the meaning of all these. That is, life, which truly bestows sovereignty, is the root of all phenomena. "Triangular": abiding as something of that shape, it abides in the aperture of Brahmā (brahmarandhra); this is called "the manner of its form." "Of the hub of perfect enjoyment" refers to the very being that abides at the hub of the lotus in which all qualities, the thirty-two excellent marks and the rest, are complete. "Tongue" is a name given to a channel. It is endowed with the drop

of bliss and with the winds, the upward-moving one and the rest. "Like the flower of the family" refers to the shape of the knots of the channels: they are like the shape of the breasts of a girl in the bloom of youth. Likewise, the other wheel, the wheel of Dharma, and the channels, the drops, the winds, and so on are to be learned from the lips of the great venerable guru.

"Because the Nonconceptual Lady embraces" refers to the bodhicitta that arises from the play of the Blessed Lady, the Great Seal, with the Blessed One, nondual and indivisible. "At that time, when it is the staff of Brahmā," and so on, refers to the time when, from the two form bodies, the Dharma body has become the gnosis of natural joy. Alternatively, "by the Nonconceptual Lady" and so on is said of the suṣumṇā, which dwells in the manner of embracing the three channels. Alternatively, the Nonconceptual Lady is the nature of the bliss of gnosis. "Embrace" means that the true one pervades the substance of the drop and embraces it indivisibly. "At that time" refers specifically to the two, the relative and the ultimate realities, that is, the supreme joy and the joy of cessation. It says "Brahmā": "of the staff of Brahmā" is explained as the staff that, at that time of natural joy, crushes all afflictive conceptions and the like. "I shall explain its time" is a pledge to explain, from here onward, the time mentioned before: rising, setting, and so on. "Rising and setting are two" means that the times of loss, enjoyment, and so on are to be gathered under the two, means and wisdom. "Which is the staff of Brahmā" was explained before, so it is not taught here. "Knot" means the knot of the lotus and so on, that is, the lotus, the abode of the tathāgatas. "There are thirty-two" gives the number of the lotus petals. "There, below the navel, sixteen transits" and so on: from the middle of the maṇḍala's hub out to the gates, in the place of the two sets of sixteen, the encircling by the heroes and heroines is called "transit" onto the two tiers. Alternatively, "rising" is the sun rising in the wheel of enjoyment, and "setting" is the sun setting in the wheel of great bliss. "Knot" and the rest are easy to understand.

Alternatively, "Rising and setting are two" and so on: as soon as the drop of bodhicitta abides in the palace of supreme joy, that is called "rising." When it transits from there, it ceases: that is the state of setting. This is taught as follows. The phase in which bodhicitta abides at the tip of the jewel of means is enjoyment. Its passing on into the opening of wisdom's precious buddha is loss. Drawn back again, both become the very being of the gnosis of great bliss: that is the empowerment of nondual suchness. "That by which the staff of Brahmā" means that the two vessels, the jewel and the buddha, are filled

with the gnosis of bliss. "Knot" is the knot of all phenomena, conditioned and unconditioned. "There are thirty-two" means that the sixteen rains and the sixteen joys are present there.

"There, below the navel, sixteen transits" refers to what was taught before: from below the hub of means it transits to the hub of wisdom. "The sixteen transits above" means that as long as the bodhicitta that transits back to the place of means, together with the drop, the joys, and so on, remains there, that is called "time."

This is explained as follows. "Because the two, bodhicitta and wind, meet" means that when bodhicitta meets with the downward-issuing wind, that wind becomes natural joy: true, stainless, free of elaboration, utterly luminous. In such an ultimate nature there is transit, and so it says, "of the one alone, above and below." The meaning is that the transits above, below, and so on are that one alone.

"Of the first union" means joining that to these. If one asks why that is joined to that, this is taught by "means and wisdom" and so on. From the union of unborn ultimate wisdom with the special means, the relative, which is illusion, comes what is explained as "the union in which supreme gnosis and the nature of cessation are nondual." The thirty-two channels are easy to understand, so they are not explained here.

"Body and" and so on is applied to the wheels of the three families, Vairocana and the rest. "The sole Nonconceptual Lady" is the wheel of emanation. Again, the staff of life is body, lalanā is speech, and rasanā is mind. The sole Nonconceptual Lady, free of the three, body, speech, and mind, is called the natural joy of the avadhūtī. "Suṣumṇā, embracing the staff of Brahmā," means that when the life channel abides filled with bodhicitta, it is Brahmā and so on. When it does not so abide, it is not so: it is the staff of life.

"From the crown protrusion (uṣṇīṣa) of great bliss" refers to the wheel at the crown of the head, the abode of the mind of great bliss. "The crown protrusion of great bliss, upward from the wheel of wind at the tip of the jewel," means that "great bliss" marks the upper limit; that "wind" marks the lower limit, and the span enclosed between them, are to be understood by implication.

"Just as there is a great snake on the gośīrṣa sandalwood tree" means that sandalwood has both wood and fragrance, and the two exist in an indivisible way, just as the snake embraces the tree. Likewise, the two aspects of bodhicitta, fluid and bliss, cannot be told apart either; at the time of transit

they exist as a single taste, the very being of bliss, and this is what is explained as gnosis by its very nature. "Brahmā," the pure one, means that genuine gnosis makes the afflictions and the rest pure. "The core of the staff" means that this genuine gnosis, endowed with both the ultimate and the relative, dwells as the core in the middle of the staff of the channel.

"First" means the first of the sixteen: the knots of the channels, the lunar days, and so on. "Of triangular form" means that the triangular shape of the channels exists as a lotus in the aperture of Brahmā. This is explained as the first joy among the enjoyments of the wisdom consort's very being. The words from "desire, trembling" up to "natural joy" explain the second, supreme joy. The words from "the life wind of the navel" up to "clear" teach the third, the joy of cessation. The words from "of light" up to "of lightning" teach the synonyms of the fourth, natural joy.

Alternatively, the four beginning with "the hub of the wisdom consort" teach the meaning of joy. The four beginning with "the joy of desire" teach supreme joy. The four beginning with "life and" teach the meaning of the joy of cessation. The four beginning with "light" teach the meaning of natural joy. When they are divided in this way into sixty-four, it is said that the whole of emanation is joy.

Again, "desire" and so on are the synonyms of joy. "Expanding" and so on are the synonyms of supreme joy. "Blazing" and so on are the synonyms of the joy of cessation. The four called uta are synonyms for the name of natural joy. Among them, the joy of joy is the one called "desire," the supreme joy the one called "trembling," the joy of cessation the one called "going," and the joy called "joy" is a joy as well. The others too are to be understood in this way. Thus, by the fourfold division and the division by synonyms, they are further divided into sixteen. The true nature of the sixty-four daṇḍa periods, the thirty-two hours, the sixteen transits, the eight watches, the four moments, and so on is also explained in terms of these.

Having thus taught it in brief, from here on it is explained in detail. It speaks of the triangle and so on; since the triangle was taught before, it is not explained here. "Of the wisdom consort" teaches the many kinds of methods of union. "By gazing" means that it is a cause, because through it joy arises in them. "Knowing desire" means desire for the wisdom consort, that is, joy. "The life wind" is explained as the wind endowed with bodhicitta. "Of the first half of the month" means the moon of the first lunar day, the first of the month, free of

the waning fortnight and the rest. That is, as gnosis like the moon, for the span of one hour: for just that interval the gnosis abides. "Bodhicitta" means that the relative and the ultimate are joined there in the fluid. That is, once the drop called "light" has been distinguished, the drop of bliss, free of all stains such as conceptual thought, is the fruit of all the joys. "Rising" is supreme joy. "Setting" is cessation, which is like darkness.

That is abandonment. "Transit" means losing the place of supreme joy and so on without enjoying it. "Time" is neither past time nor future time, nor can it be apprehended as "present": it is a time that cannot be apprehended. At such a time it is the time when flowers, fruits, and the like flourish. That is, the wind neither moves outward nor moves inward. As the tantra says:

The time of strong flow
And the time that is not strong are the two times,
Those of the two nostrils.
That which is neither of the two, reality itself,

and so on.

"The desire of the lotus fruit": the channel has a shape like a lotus fruit, and the "desire" for it is the methods of union of many kinds and so on, the cause from which joy arises. That arises in dependence on the action seal and the like. "The body trembles" means that, arising from that, the wisdom consort, as the cause of the joy of trembling and the rest, makes what arises and what is supported tremble. Endowed with the wind called "fault," and abiding in the drop called "strength," the fruit ripens. "The name of Rudra" refers to the channel's shape, which is like a rudrākṣa; by this, "the eye of Rudra" is indicated. "Going" means that bodhicitta does not stay; it is a synonym of joy. "Equal" is the name of the fire-accompanying wind (samāna). "Endowed" means endowed with joy and wind: it is endowed with everything, bodhicitta and the rest. "Cloud" is a synonym for the name of the drop of bliss; at that time it is endowed with everything. "Flower of the family" and the rest are to be learned from the guru.

"Lightning is what terrifies and frightens" means: just as one takes fright when lightning falls or strikes, so natural joy, free of all elaboration, has come to stand on top of all the joys; and further, "lightning," understood as a synonym of natural joy, makes the joy of cessation and the rest fear and dread. If one asks, "Then what is natural joy like?": it is unequaled by any joy, and without substance. The sequel to the Subsequent Tantra also says:

Natural joy is not an entity,
Nor is it a non-entity.
It is neither existence nor nirvāṇa;
It is not rain, drop, or mode,

and so on. The Essence Tantra also says:

Free of loss, enjoyment, and the rest,
It cannot be expressed through the joys.
The deity who vanquishes the drop and the rest:
That itself is natural gnosis.

Therefore it has nothing in common with any gnosis that appears as signs.

"There, there are sixteen settings" means that bodhicitta's not being clear is reckoned as sixteen. "Wherever there is rising and setting" means that enjoyment, loss, and so on are not called natural joy. That is why it says, "Natural joy is not there": in natural joy there is no gnosis of signs, such as the states of rising and setting, enjoyment, and the like. "The crooked beam" means the lalanā, which lies on the left side like a chain. "The hub of the root" and so on: at each knot of the hub of the life channel, with each drop of bodhicitta, joy, the rain, the mode, and the rest, as they transit, arise, and abide, are applied to rising, setting, time, and so on. "Such great blisses" means that the division, on the relative level, of the nature of great bliss taught before is what is called "kinds." "I have explained them as transits" means "I explained them before as the sixteen transits": the Teacher has already explained them.

Having explained it in this way, from here on he teaches in detail what was condensed. In "The real, the support, and discernment" and so on, "the real" is the thirty-two methods of union with the action seal, gazing and the rest: joy, the wheel of emanation, and so on. Alternatively, "the real" is bodhicitta's resting, through the commitment seal (samayamudrā), in the knots of those channels; and supreme joy, the wheel of Dharma, and so on. Again, "the support" means realizing, through the gnosis seal, that the support of one's own bliss rests on the drop of bodhicitta. "Gnosis" is the gnosis seal, known and realized by oneself: knowing it as arising from the two, genuine bodhicitta and relative bodhicitta; or the joy of cessation, the wheel of enjoyment, and so on. Alternatively, "gnosis" is knowing it as the bodhicitta known through the seal of the nature of phenomena. "Discernment" means realizing, through the seal of the nature of phenomena, the nature of great bliss by discerning it as

free from cognition; or natural joy, the wheel of great bliss, and so on. Alternatively, "discernment" means discerning the nature of bodhicitta, free of all seals, and so abandoning even gnosis together with its basis.

Having thus taught the condensed division, I shall explain the extensive division. "The real is gazing in equal taste" means that from means and wisdom, the churner and the churned, the sign of the taste of gnosis arises evenly. "Passion": through attachment and clinging to the five sense pleasures, form, sound, smell, taste, touch, and so on, one obtains the fruit of saṃsāra; but through the various practices, the generation stage and the rest, they become good qualities. Since the fruit, the form body, arises from this, it purifies the habitual tendencies of the ordinary. "Of union, producing touch" means that this experience of the bliss of touch through the union of means and wisdom purifies conceptual thought and the like. "The real makes existence cease" and so on means that the real does away with the habitual tendencies of the three realms, good, bad, and so on, which are produced by karma and afflictions. Further, there are the enjoyments of the various methods of union: kissing, marking with the nails, caressing the breasts, embracing, and so on. In this way, all phenomena of apprehended and apprehender are cut off by the real.

"Through the arising of the puṇḍarīka" means that the white mind, the color of a white flower, serves as an example illustrating the white color of bodhicitta, which arises in the knots of the channels. "Triangle" and so on means that the thirty-two knots, which resemble a triangle, a lotus fruit, Rudra's eye, and so on, serve as the support. "Is supported" means that the channels act as the support of bodhicitta. "The supported is without meditative concentration" and so on means that there is no meditator there: it is free of both the yogin and the object of meditation; therefore it is the expanse of phenomena (dharmadhātu), free of elaboration.

"The support of the equality of above and below" and so on means that all the winds, such as the wind that moves upward, are gathered into one, and from the time they are gathered there is no realizing or abiding, even as mere gnosis. "The support of the nectar of great bliss": that nature of utter bliss is the support that has become the elixir against the afflictions and the rest. "The supreme ground of the five families": the ground of the five, the aggregate of form and the rest, is space, Vajrasattva. Alternatively, the five cakras are the five families, and their supreme ground is the cakra of great bliss, that of the sixth family. This is explained where it says, "from churning the white bliss."

"Gnosis, desire spontaneously accomplished" means that all the joys are subsumed under interrupted joy. If one asks, "Then are they also subsumed under intrinsic joy?": even if they are subsumed under intrinsic joy, there is no contradiction, for without relying on interrupted joy, intrinsic joy is not found. There is also no contradiction because intrinsic joy does not exist apart from the three joys. Just as, for example, the mind is not found without a body, so intrinsic joy is not attained without relying on interrupted joy. Were it not so, there would be a fault, and therefore this too was said:

Relying upon the apprehended,
Seek out thoroughly the unapprehended.

And: "It is like, for example, a flower and its scent." It is shown by these examples.

In the passage beginning "Trembling, joy, supreme joy," that supreme joy experiences gnosis in a manner accompanied by conceptual thought. As soon as one simply abides in bliss within the meaning thus experienced, then, from the mind's abiding one-pointed and undistracted, intrinsic joy comes to be accomplished as something not found. At that point, what is free of all the gnoses of attachment and the rest is intrinsic joy. This shows the interrupted joy that is accompanied by attachment:

Intrinsic joy is without a basis;
Interrupted joy has a basis.

So it is said. "Gnosis brings about freedom from pride" means that this is accomplished by abandoning the pride that thinks, "This is the limit of reality." "Fully knows all phenomena" means knowing without exception the phenomena comprised by the outer and the phenomena comprised by the inner. "Gnosis accomplishes the aims of the knowable" means accomplishing the aims of all, such as the common accomplishments. "The Discerner, renowned as a form of light" means that bodhicitta, the Discerner, that supreme light free of all conceptual elaboration, cannot be reached by words. "The nature of mode, cloud, and power": because it is the nature of the sixteen drops of bliss, it is called "the Discerner." "In all things" means all that appears as things. "Destroys, together with the four aspects" means "destroys them all, without remainder and together with their habitual tendencies." "Of the miraculous power of birth and abiding" means that displaying the miracle of birth, and cessation, and abiding and so on, are also qualities. "The Discerner slays delusion" means that destroying the afflictions is being free of them.

"All the essence of the channels": the channels number seventy-two thousand, and their essence is the channel endowed with the cakras and bodhicitta. This light, too, is exhausted and made nonexistent. "In cakra, mantra, and activity" refers to the maṇḍala, the cakra, wisdom, compassion, action, and so on. "That destroyer is the Discerner" concerns all the phenomena explained above, such as the maṇḍala. "Because it has destroyed" and what follows are not explained, since they are easy to understand.

"In all buddhas and bodhisattvas" means the buddhas of the eleventh ground and so on, and the bodhisattvas of the tenth ground and below. "Always dwells in the heart" means that intrinsic joy is the nature of the bodhicitta of all of them. Alternatively, "buddhas" and so on are the five aggregates and so on, and "all bodhisattvas" are the sense sources, such as the sense faculties. "In the heart": in the center of the lotus at its heart, the seed of bodhicitta dwells like the moon, as a conventional entity. "The Discerner is without meditation" means that the nature of reality, truly that itself, cannot be meditated upon as anything at all. "Free of aggregates, elements, and the rest" means free of all conditioned things: the five aggregates, the eighteen elements, the sense sources, and so on. "Empty of phenomena such as sound" means empty of all phenomena such as sound and valid cognition. "It is the nature of emptiness and compassion" means that intrinsic joy arises from the two: emptiness, which is unborn wisdom, and compassion, which is the special skillful means.

As for "Brahmā" and the rest: Brahmā is Amoghasiddhi. He is gnosis, and the nature of all gnoses is the diligent performance of deeds. If one asks, "Then why is gnosis called Brahmā?": whatever is pure of all conceptual thought is called Brahmā. This, moreover, appears in these words:

The intrinsic nature of the habitual tendencies of things,
Being pure without being abandoned, is held to be gnosis.

This is taught as follows:

Where the ultimate and the conventional,
The two truths, are mingled, by that mingling
The drop of bodhicitta is pervaded;
At that time Brahmā holds gnosis.

So it is said. And by these words:

In the center of space, the blissful drop:
This is the very reality of bodhicitta.

Its nature single, free of things,
At that time it is the nature of Brahmā.

By this it is shown that Brahmā is Amoghasiddhi. "Viṣṇu" is Ratnasambhava. Likewise, Amitābha is Rudra: having vanquished all adverse factors, he gives discriminating gnosis. Īśvara (the Lord) is Akṣobhya. Sadāśiva (the eternal Śiva) is Vairocana. These are also applied to the five, beginning with the wind cakra. "All of those": "those" refers to what has just been mentioned, and "all of them" refers to the five families. "Is the father" refers to that lord, Vajrasattva, the lord of the inexpressible gnosis of suchness, free of elaboration.

If the gnosis free of elaboration is the Dharma body, great bliss, are the two not contradictory, since Vajrasattva is a form body? They are not contradictory. "Vajra" is the indivisible nature of the five gnoses. "Sattva" is acting for the benefit of sentient beings through emanations and so on. That is to say, from intrinsic joy, free of all elaboration, there gradually comes the enjoyment body, complete with all the major marks, and emanating from that, he acts for their benefit.

The one who acts is supremely wondrous,
Here in this very drop of gnosis.

This refers to intrinsic joy, the sixteenth, the essence of all the drops of bliss, which is unequaled by interrupted joy and supreme joy. Therefore it says, "Lord who has accomplished all that is supreme." "Present within all the elements" and so on means that it is present within the elements: earth, water, fire, wind, and the rest. "Of the five bodies" refers to Vairocana and the rest; it is their lord. "The nature of the five spaces, unborn" is easy to understand. "Dissolves into the five spaces" means that it is gathered into the five: earth, water, fire, wind, and consciousness. "All the buddhas pay homage" means that this is done by all the buddhas without exception, Vairocana and the rest.

Such great secret gnosis,
Like stolen wealth, so that it is not found,
Should be concealed with effort.

This means that, having separated off conceptual thought and everything adverse, and having obtained through empowerment and the rest that Discerner, the intrinsic joy so very hard to find, one should then hold it in the

mind.

This is the explanation of the difficult points of the first chapter, from the Lamp of Innate Joy.

Here a question is asked about the meaning of what the Blessed One taught at first. "The Lord of Gods said" are the words of the compiler. "O Blessed One" is an address in pleasing words. Dividing the three, beginning with the three realities, into four, he asks. "The Blessed One said" means that he spoke in the midst of the whole retinue, the Lord of Gods and the rest.

The three realities are body, speech, and mind;
The three vajras are supreme gnosis.

This means: the vajra of body is Vairocana, supreme joy; Amitābha, interrupted joy, is the vajra of speech; and Vajrasattva is the vajra of gnosis, intrinsic joy.

The moon within supreme bliss:
That is the aggregates, faculties, and elements.

This means the maṇḍala of the tathāgatas of the five families and the rest, who are the five aggregates and the rest; of the bodhisattvas, who are the faculties and the rest; and of the goddesses and the rest, who are the elements and the rest. Alternatively, it is the essence of bodhicitta. "Mahāmudrā, the vajra essence" is the gnosis being, which abides primordially. Alternatively, it is the gnosis of bliss.

Its end is known to be in the bhaga.

This means the Buddha, the Blessed One himself. Alternatively, all those mentioned above abide in the bhaga of wisdom.

The end and appearance are cognized,
And seen like the moon in water.

This refers to the two among the three joys that are causes of intrinsic joy: as conventional things, in the state of interrupted joy, they appear like the moon in water, but ultimately they are simply empty. In "All phenomena are by nature stainless," the phenomena are apprehended and apprehender, and their purity is the stainless joy. "Everything arises from appearance" means that intrinsic joy arises from the attainment of appearance and so on. "Without arising or ceasing" means that this genuine, stainless one is empty of the essence of all phenomena. "Everything arises from the genuine light" means

that from this comes interrupted joy, and from that, supreme joy, in sequence. "Therefore, the nature of all phenomena" means that all conditioned and unconditioned phenomena without exception arise from this. "It is the Blessed One, glorious Jñānatilaka" refers to the Blessed One, the body of great bliss, whose nature is the reality of the four bodies.

As for "There, first, meditating on the generation of the maṇḍala cakra endowed with aspects, and": the fourth, tenth, and seventeenth chapters teach the maṇḍala endowed with aspects. The eleventh teaches the generation of the maṇḍala. The fifth teaches mantra. Recitation is in the eleventh. The fire offering is taught in the fourteenth. The sacrificial offering is taught in the sixth and eleventh. The torma is taught in the ninth and fifteenth. Worship is taught in the seventh and twelfth. The places are in the first. Empowerment is taught in the third and thirteenth. Of these, which come in no order, it is said, "I have explained them." Moreover, up through the ninth chapter this is explicit; the others are hidden, and here I have opened them up.

This is the explanation of the difficult points of the second chapter, from the Lamp of Intrinsic Joy.

"The Lord of Gods said" are the words of the questioner. The passage from "of Brahmā" up to "the others were not taught here" is the substance of what the compiler Vajrapāṇi asked. "The Blessed One said" means that he spoke to the retinue, together with the heroes and heroines. It speaks of "the sole Nonconceptual Lady, suṣumṇā": this excludes the others. "Seven hundred and twenty million" and so on is said by way of summary, meaning that this one performs the function of all of them. "The Lord of Gods said": although that had been given, he asks, as the words show, "Even so, though the function is indeed the meaning in brief..." "The names and the number of the thirty-one" and so on is the question. With this, regarding the cakra of great bliss, which has thirty-two channels, he asks merely for an enumeration, by way of one name for each, apart from the avadhuti. "Listen to the names of the thirty-one channels": these are the channels through which bliss flows, namely "Secret" and the rest. The names of the channels such as Secret are either simply fixed or describe what is experienced through them; they are assigned by way of function, nature, and so on. Since there are many if one divides them, a condensed division is taught here. In brief, the division of the kinds of channels is said to be ten.

Three drops of bodhicitta:
First, from appearance in space,
Iḍā, piṅgalā, and suṣumṇā
Arise, and that is the cause.
The others arise from them,
And the later arise from the earlier in sequence.
All such divisions
Are held to be the special cause.
By the division of each channel's purity,
Gods and goddesses appear as a cakra.
This maṇḍala, complete and lacking nothing,
Unfolds the sublime outer result.
The earlier are rightly causes,
And the later, likewise, are results.
What is called "the special result"
I have explained to be this.
Shapes, colors, and signs:
Whatever is distinctly clear in each
Appears as its own nature;
Realized thus, it is "the special."
Because they are linked in the network of channels,
This is held to be the etymological definition.
And because it pervades,
I have shown it here as "the special."
The cakra of great bliss
Is filled with bodhicitta.

And that flows down through all the channels;
This action is what is called "the general."
Flesh, blood, feces, urine, eye-rheum, snot,
Nails, head hair, body hair, bones, sinews,
Kidneys, heart, bones, lungs,
Intestines, grime, fat, and pus,
Bile, wrinkles, belly, beard,
Phlegm, menses, tears, brain,
Marrow, semen, blood, and flesh:
To bring these down is the special action,
Serving as the support for the knots and the rest.

This, which knows and is aware,
Is therefore the experience of gnosis;
The signs of that experience are the characteristic.
And that gnosis, distinctly clear in each,
Is explained as what is called "the special."
As for the name, they are designated "channels,"
Which is to name them in general terms;
Whatever name is given to each one singly
Is particular, and so it states that.
From the three channels down to the pores:
This is the division of the channels.
Six cakras, and four, and one;
The particular divisions are iḍā and the rest.
The life-staff stands upright in the center;
It should be known as the support of all.
Resting one upon another, the support of all
And the particular ones that rest on it are each distinct,
Just as, for example, a tree or the like
Is adorned with branches, leaves, and fruit.
In just this way, this division
One should strive to understand in its meaning.
If there were no channels, there would be no aggregates;
And since without the aggregates there would be no bliss,
Just as without a flower there is no fragrance,
The supreme result, therefore, would not be attained.
So that it may be heard,
Summed up in brief, there are these ten.
This meaning, without error,
One should ask of the guru again and again.

Therefore, since this is difficult to understand, one should nevertheless understand, by way of the condensed meaning, to what the names "Secret," "Profound," and so on are applied.

The passage beginning "Those are the thirty-two channels" is easy to understand.

"It swells at the juncture when the moon and sun are eclipsed by Rāhu" means that both the jewel of method and wisdom alike and the vessel of the

buddha-jewel swell with great bliss. When intrinsic gnosis is stable in the interval between the joy of cessation and the supreme joy, that is explained as "eclipsed by Rāhu."

Now that the meaning of the channels has been taught, the sequence of empowerment is taught. "Then" is a word signifying unbroken connection. "The sequence of empowerment is explained" is said with reference to the Vase, the Secret, the Wisdom-Gnosis, and the Fourth empowerments. "In the proper order" means that the earlier are causes and the later ones results; the sequence should be followed without error.

"Whoever is gratified by the supreme empowerment" means that the fourth is found through the sequence of cause and result, but it is not found directly. "Becomes capable in all things" is explained to mean that the yogin who has obtained the fourth accomplishes the common and the supreme attainments and so forth, and also whatever he intends. By this, the benefits and the result of empowerment are shown.

"A son endowed with good qualities and moral discipline" is a disciple who is a fit vessel, who has good fortune, and who guards the vows and the pledges (samaya). "The guru should first confer empowerment" means that the guru who has become supreme among all should confer the sequence of empowerment on that disciple who possesses all the marks.

On whom, endowed with the marks, is it to be conferred? If it is said that the Blessed One shows no partiality toward any sentient being, that is so; nevertheless, those who in former times did not show honor, service, and so on to the Tathāgata have weak merit, and so in this life, in later lives, and at other times they will not meet with the blessing of the Blessed One. Because they do not meet with it, they are neither fit vessels nor possessed of the characteristics. Thus it is said:

Whoever is an actual monk,
Whoever abides as an elder,
And any person who delights in conceptual thought:
To them one should not teach reality.

Furthermore:

Non-Buddhists (tīrthikas), actual śrāvakas,
And eunuchs do not obtain empowerment.

In this tantra too, the passage beginning "Whose net" is taught. Therefore, the empowerment of Secret Mantra is not conferred on one who is not a fit vessel. There is no contradiction regarding the marks and so forth; what the Blessed One said was also spoken with an underlying intention.

Bathed, eyes covered and bound with a cloth,
Cupped hands filled with flowers,
Having offered the fee, and joyful:
The Īśvara of the gods should confer empowerment.

Regarding these lines: beforehand, once the rites of the ground, the lines of the maṇḍala, the preparatory rite, the consecration, the ablution, and so on have all been completed, the rite of covering the eyes is performed. Then the scattering of flowers to the guru, the scattering onto the maṇḍala, and the whole sequence from the rite of the pledges up to the offering of the fee should all be carried out at the time of receiving the empowerment.

"Through empowerment, the buddha grounds" means that one attains them from the eleventh up to the sixteenth. "Will be found without doubt" means that one should not entertain hesitation or two-mindedness as to whether one attains them through it within that interval.

"Therefore, striving in every way, one should take up the glorious king of empowerments" means that the disciple should please the guru with honors, fees, and so on, and the guru in turn bestows the king of empowerments in full, up to the fourth, without error in sequence or meaning.

"The divisions according to the empowerments" means: the first is the Vase, the second the Secret, the third Wisdom-Gnosis, and the fourth is likewise thus. "These are the divisions of the master and the rest," and what follows, is easy to understand.

"The full division of twice four" means that twice four is eight. The Vase empowerment possesses the result of Akṣobhya, and so too the crown, the vajra, the bell, and the name. The vajra discipline, the prediction, the granting of protection, and so on: the conferral of these eight empowerments is the master's empowerment.

"The vajra empowerment is divided into three; I have made it clear as equal to space" means that the vajra master's empowerment is shown to have its source equal to space; it is the empowerment of the three pledges.

"That empowerment is precious, paid homage by the three realms" means this: one who has received the eleven empowerments, with a vase holding medicines, grains, jewels, and so on, or with the five nectars and so on, and in whom all of it is complete, is an object of homage and offerings for the three worlds. Alternatively, if empowerment is conferred with the inner master's vase and so on, or if the empowerment of the secret disciple's own vase and so on is conferred in full, the three realms will actually pay homage. Or else, the vajra of method, in which the vessel of the buddha-jewel, the five kinds of jewels, and so on are present, is empowered and is complete as the very essence of what is worthy of homage; and the same holds for wisdom. Or else, since the sequence of the benefits of empowerment is set out clearly, those who wish to know it should look there.

"For those devoted to the Yoga Tantra" means that it is done for disciples who delight in the outer Yoga. "One should grant the eight empowerments in their divisions" means: water, crown, vajra, bell, and name; these five are the five families.

The discipline, the prediction, and the granting of protection are as taught before.

"For those devoted to the Higher Yoga" concerns the method of attaining the great yoga. "One should grant the elevenfold" means that, on top of the previous ones, there are the three pledges of the vajra body and so on, making eleven. "For those devoted to the Yoginī" refers to the mother tantras. "The Secret empowerment is granted" refers to the supreme twelfth. The passage beginning "Two secrets" is easy to understand. "It is divided into three secrets": the three are shown below. "Birth" is the site of supreme joy at the birth of the jewel. "Knot" is the tip of the avadhūtī, the site of the intrinsic nature. "Likewise" is the opening of the wisdom consort's lotus, the site of cessation.

"Wisdom is to be divided into two, by the distinction of generation and completion" means this: the outer is drinking from the lotus of the wisdom consort, and that is generation; drinking the nectar by means of caṇḍālī (inner heat) and so on is completion.

From here on, the characteristics of the secret consort are taught. "A wisdom consort of twice eight years": a young woman sixteen years of age, or, if there is none, one of twenty. "Long-eyed" means that her eyes are quick-glancing and her eyebrows meet without a break, black and glossy. "Skilled in

enjoyment" means skilled in the practices of the sixty methods of union and so on, and in the sequence of empowerment. "Her limbs have the scent of fresh sandalwood" means that an exceedingly sweet fragrance comes from her body and all her limbs. "Satisfying with exceedingly smooth fluid," it says; that is, the cause of gnosis is blissful and satisfying, endowed with smoothness through bodhicitta such as storax and camphor. "Beautiful in form, dark, and fortunate" means that her body is not stout, slender yet not too thin, her complexion a dark blue-green; she is a good vessel and of great wisdom. The passage beginning "Breasts" means that the disciple should strive to seek out one whose breasts are full and rising, whose waist is slender, and who has boundless good qualities such as faith; and, for the sake of receiving the Secret empowerment, having offered her, a woman of good family, he should obtain the Secret empowerment through the verses of supplication to the guru and so on.

The instruction on empowerment is divided into three;
The inner one gives the sign;
The fourth is known as the nature of the result:
Free of the three, it is the very self of the three.

This means: having distinguished the Vase, the Secret, and the Wisdom-Gnosis, the descent in stages into the cakras of gnosis through the union of the khakhvamukha and the bola and so on, that is, the descent to the crown, the throat, and the heart, is in actuality the generation stage. As for completion, the fourth, which arises when joy, supreme joy, the joy of cessation, and so on are joined in sequence with the three empowerments, is the result. Moreover:

It is not found in the three and the rest,
Nor is it the three themselves;
It is like the light of a lamp's circle.

"Joy and the rest, in their particulars, are made clear by the vajra maiden" means that the genuine gnosis of joy, supreme joy, and so on arises clearly from the nonduality of method and wisdom; and that arises from a wisdom consort endowed with the marks. Further, the passage beginning "The three tantras" is taught. The passage beginning "Through empowerment" teaches the benefits of empowerment. "They arise in sequence, one from another" means that the earlier is the cause and the later, in sequence, the result. It says, "One should receive it from the lips of an excellent guru." Such a guru

has obtained all the empowerments, is learned in the tantras, the instructions, the empowerments, and so on, and has attained accomplishment. "He goes to the Avīci hell" shows the fault: if one does not please the guru, through that fault one goes to hell. Therefore, avoiding that fault, one should strive to please the guru with offerings, fees, and the like.

This is the explanation of the difficult points of the third chapter, from the Lamp of Intrinsic Joy.

Now that one has been made a fit vessel through empowerment, the sequence of meditation is taught. "Then listen: I shall explain yet more" means that immediately after empowerment has been explained, the meaning of the abode is taught. "Having one pillar and nine doors" means that the life-staff serves as the pillar, which holds sway over the nine doors. The vajra walls: each channel, in the form of a body hair, is filled with bodhicitta, and thereby the whole body is pervaded by the network of channels. All the channels, awakened through their nature of bliss, have the nature of the five kinds of gnosis. The indivisible nature of these gnoses is that of the vajra; therefore it is "adorned with vajra walls." The vajra lines are those marked out by the divisions of the channels. "The canopy" refers to the cakra of great bliss and so on, and it says that by this everything is pervaded and encircled on all sides.

"It is divided in the order of wind and the rest; it possesses the four elements" means that, following the passage beginning "From yaṃ, a blue wind maṇḍala," one should visualize them in sequence at the secret place, the navel, the emanation cakra, and the heart. Or else, when the wind kindles the fire, all the channels open, and from that the nature of great bliss arises, present in a special way in the four cakras.

"Throughout all of space, to every limit, the self of all ever abides" means that the cakra of great bliss is called "space"; pervading the other cakras and as far as the outermost channels, it abides throughout the whole body as the very self of intrinsic joy. Alternatively, "space" is the source of phenomena (dharmodaya), which is exceedingly vast; within it, all is just as was taught for the outer maṇḍala: the celestial palace generated from the earth maṇḍala, Mahendra, and so on. The meaning of this is as follows:

The maṇḍala is taught as body,
And likewise taught as speech;
As mind, bodhicitta is explained.

By this one should understand the three: outer, inner, and secret. Or else, one should look for this secret in the tenth chapter.

As for "Like the turning of the protection wheel," this and the rest are easy to understand, so they are not explained. Reality is taught in brief. At the time of the great yoga, having found the vessel of the buddha-jewel and guarded the bodhicitta and the sun, that which then abides once more in the maṇḍala at the hub of the wheel is not given as a cause for outer realization. The inner object of touch, exceedingly smooth, appears conventionally like the moon in water, and what appears as though inseparable from it is what is called "the great gnosis." This is the instruction.

The passage beginning "On the ten-spoked, golden in color" is easy to understand, so it is not explained. Here, the hub of the wheel, triangular in shape, the hare-marked moon, is what is called "the source of phenomena."

On the ten-spoked wheel, golden in color, that holds the ten, Yamāntaka and the rest, there is at the hub in its center the darmotaya, white in color, the very essence of bodhicitta. This is the source from which all phenomena, apprehended and apprehender and the rest, arise. It is to be distinguished in stages, as explained before.

"In its center" is to be understood as the hub of the wheel. "Taught before" means as it was taught at the words "of wind and the rest." The four elements are these four: wind, fire, water, and earth, and all phenomena arise from them. As for the order: from yaṃ raṃ vaṃ laṃ come the four, wind and the rest, and above them, from bhrūṃ, the wheel. All of these melt into light, and from that comes Vairocana. "From the transformation of Vairocana" means that he melts into light and the palace is formed.

"Possessing the eight charnel grounds": this is shown by the words "the charnel ground called Terrible, a place haunted by hungry ghosts, and Repulsive," and so on. It is the abode that possesses these. "Immeasurable" means free of reckoning, measurement, and limit: because the abode of Vajradhara is free of anything cramped and the like, it is a great and spacious mansion. "The two tiers" means that it is divided into outer and inner. "On a sun seat" means a male and a female māra upon the sun. "Variegated" is easy to understand. "At the hub of the eight petals" means that in the center, with the fourth left aside, there are the sun and the rest, as before.

"The very nature of the mode and the drop" means the mode in which the drop, the substance of the Word, abides within ā. From these two come the

vowels and consonants. The vowels run from a ā to aṃ aḥ, and the consonants from ka kha to ha kṣaḥ. There are, moreover, the samaya vowels and the gnosis vowels, and the same holds for the consonants. "Arisen from the two" refers to the moon and the sun, which arise from those two. As for the two syllables maṃ hūṃ, the very nature of method and wisdom, there are the vajra and the curved knife bearing these seeds. The one who rises from all of these in a body of method and wisdom is called glorious Jñānatilaka. "Embraced by the Great Seal" means "relying on method and wisdom"; broken down into its divisions, it is easy to understand.

Now the colors, shapes, and so on are taught. "Eight faces, eight arms, the right leg outstretched" means that he possesses such qualities as the eight liberations; relate this to the tenth chapter. "The four faces" are half of the eight, drawn from the root. "Black" means that one should imagine the central face as matching the body. The yellow one is on the right, the red one on the left, and the one at the back is green. "The other four are like blue lotuses" means that the four apart from those already named resemble blue utpalas. The vajra and the rest are in the eight hands, on the right and on the left. The crown of the head is adorned with a crossed vajra (viśvavajra). The passage beginning "Moon" is easy to understand. "The body bound with the six seals" refers to the wheel and the rest, which are the very nature of the six families. The rest should be understood in the same way.

This is the explanation of the difficult points of the fourth chapter, from the Lamp of Intrinsic Joy.

"Now the supreme mantra shall be explained" means that here the heart mantra is laid open and explained. With the passage beginning "By which the practitioner succeeds," the outer, the inner, the secret, suchness, and the rest are to be explained. "Practitioner" means the yogin. "By which" is the special method. "Succeeds" means succeeding through that mantra, that is, gaining the supreme accomplishment and the rest. Now, in Sanskrit, mantra is mantra:

man is emptiness, free of signs,
Free of color and the rest, its very self the nature of reality,
The solace of Vajradhara:
This is explained as wisdom.
tra is gnosis and bliss,
Abiding as the form body with the major and minor marks,
Solace in the Tathāgata:

This I explain as great compassion.
That in which these two, compassion and wisdom,
Abide as one,
The way of the thing that is no thing,
That is what is taught as mantra.
Knowing the Great Seal of this kind,
Its very self the supreme name,
No name at all, a name that signifies:
Whoever realizes this has the accomplishment of mantra.

This explains it as wisdom and compassion. Why are other matters, such as the etymology of mantra, not taught? They are not taught here; for them, look to the stages of the qualities of empowerment.

"Make a lotus of eight petals" means that one should draw it with its petals and its center. "Vajra" means that one should meditate on Vajrakumāra, with three faces and six arms. "Ten ritual daggers" gives their number. "The wise one should affix the mantra of the wrathful one" means that, imagining Vajrakumāra as the wrathful one, the yogin should affix oṃ vajrakīli and so on, one by one, in the directions and the intermediate directions.

The text says, "Having made the vowels and consonants equal." The vowels are the sixteen letters of wisdom. The consonants are the thirty-three letters of method, kā and the rest. "Made equal" means that the two, the sixteen vowels and the thirty-three consonants, are joined together. By this the cause is taught. "Arrange them in order on all the petals" teaches the support and the supported.

Alternatively, it is the heart mantra, and it is explained like this: the ritual daggers are ten, the sense source of the eye faculty, the ḍākinī of delusion, and so on, and this point will be explained by the venerable guru in due order. The vowels are the sixteen of the enjoyment wheel. The consonants are the thirty-two channels of the great bliss wheel together with the staff of life. "Having made them equal" means that all of these are endowed with bodhicitta. "Arrange them in order on all the petals" means that they are to be set out in full on all of them. Then, when the heart mantra and the other mantras are extracted in order, the father's heart mantra is counted out from the channels of method, the mother's heart mantra is counted out from the channels of wisdom, and so on.

Alternatively, the consonants are the movement through sixteen lunar days, from the triangle and the rest until the sesame flower is in full bloom, and then sixteen more going upward again, making thirty-two. The vowels are the sixteen blisses that arise from the thirty-two. "Having made them equal" means that, since the seminal fluid and the bliss are equal, it has the nature of the sixteen joys. That is the heart mantra of method; the one for wisdom should be understood on one's own. Or else, the sixteen intrinsic natures being complete in the sixteen joys is the one for wisdom. The passage beginning "on all the petals" is easy to understand.

Or again, the vowels are the eight-petaled lotus of wisdom: in the eight drops, the substance of the conventional moon, the eight ultimate intrinsic natures are complete. The consonants, those of method, are to be set out in the same way. "Having made them equal" means that they are equal at the center of the hub, and that is the very nature of empty space.

"Arrange them in order on all the petals" means the absence of any pervading of all things by intrinsic joy. That, moreover, which is free of words, without letters, invisible, not found by analysis, free of beginning and end, boundless, and marvelous, is called the suchness of intrinsic gnosis. By this, mantra is taught.

"The vowels, on one petal of gnosis" means that all sixteen are to be set on a single petal. "The consonants on seven petals" means that there are seven. "Five letters on each petal" means that, except for two of the seven, five are to be placed on each. "Five each, up to the fifth" means five on each petal: ka kha ga gha ṅa on one, and likewise for ca and the rest. On two petals there are two sets of four: on one, the four ya ra la va, and on the second, śa ṣa sa ha, four. "The syllable kṣa is inside" means that within the eight-petaled lotus one should imagine kṣa, the intrinsic nature of Vajrasattva.

The vowels are ā i ī u ū ṛ ṝ ḷ ḹ e ai o au aṃ. The consonants are ka kha ga gha ṅa, ca cha ja jha ña, ṭa ṭha ḍa ḍha ṇa, ta tha da dha na, pa pha ba bha ma, ya ra la va, śa ṣa sa ha. By the statement that these two are conceived as āli kālī, their distinction is also taught. "With the petals bearing the letters of the two" refers to the letters of method and wisdom.

"Extract that very king of mantras" refers to the father's heart mantra and near-heart mantra, and the mother's heart mantra and near-heart mantra. "First, the mighty king of form" means, at the very first, the seed of Vairocana, the syllable oṃ. "Then, the first of the second petal" means, immediately after

that, the first of the second, śa. "With the fourth vowel": the fourth vowel is ī, and "together with" means śa joined with ī. "Below" means below śi. repha is another name for rā. Adorned with it, these form śri ri. "The one that has twenty-five" indicates ma. "The fourth of the second petal" means the fourth, hā. "Joined with the second vowel" means ā: ha joined with ā gives hā. "Purifying the lower realms of saṃsāra" means that the Great Glorious One liberates all the māras and the rest and makes them into the very nature of gnosis.

"With the fourth of the first of the two petals": from this point on it is taught through oral instruction. The fourth of the first is va. Then the eighth consonant is ja. "With the second of the first of the two petals" is ra. "Joined, it robs all in turn" means that when it stands joined to ja it is called vajra. The vajra cuts and pierces all things, and so on. "The third consonant" is ga. "Fully joined with the tenth" means le, joined to ga. The passage beginning "the vowel letter" has already been taught. The fifth of the fourth is na. Then its first, ta. "The sixteenth," "joined with the third": the third is i, so it is joined as ti. "The ground of all mantra words" means that this is the root, or the ground. After that come the pure ones. "Likewise the first consonant" is ka. "The limb, the thirty-third consonant" is ha. "Fully joined with the sixth vowel" means ū: ha joined with ū is hū. From it all phenomena arise; its divisions should be learned from the master's own mouth. "The crescent moon" is ṅa. "The drop" is easy to understand. "That" means that from these hūṃ is formed. "Abiding near that hūṃ" is hūṃ again, so that in effect two are formed. "The lord of mind, the supreme letter" means that this cause for generating the Blessed One is the supreme of all letters. "That which is the second of the fifth" is pha; joined with ṭa, the first of the third, it is phaṭ. At the end it is joined with svāhā, that is, at the foot of all of them. "The heart mantra, truly supreme" refers to the father's heart mantra.

"First, the supreme of form" means the seed of form, oṃ. The fourth of the second petal is ha. "Fully joined with repha below" is ra. "Combined with the fourth vowel" means ī: combining the three, ha, ra, and ī, gives hrī. "The supreme letter of the king of knowledge" means the heart of knowledge. "Its head pressed by a drop" means hrīṃ. With the words "abiding right beside it," hrī is extracted again. "All-peaceful, the supreme peaceful lady" means the intrinsic nature of great bliss. "The thirty-third pressed by a drop" is haṃ. "The second of the sixteen" is ā, and "joined" means haṃ joined with ā, hāṃ. "Or else, that very supreme letter" is haṃ. "It splits open the black darkness of the

three realms" is said in terms of its qualities. "Join that hūṃ phaṭ to both" means that each one is also joined twice over. At the end it is joined with svā and hā. "This is called the near-heart mantra" covers everything up to this point. "The Blessed One, Jñānatilaka" means that it is the Blessed One alone.

"First, Vairocana" means the pure entity, oṃ. "The twenty-ninth of them" is va. "The letter that is the eighth consonant" is the letter ja. "With the twenty-seventh" is ra. Joined with ja and ra, it is vajra. "The other, the twenty-fifth" indicates ma. "The seventh vowel" is ṛ; joined with ma, it is mṛ. "The third from the fourth" shows da. "Next to it is wind" shows the seed of wind, ya. The eleventh vowel is e, joined to ya. "The fifth of the fifth" is ma. ha is easy to understand. "And the third of the fifth" shows ba. "Then the twenty-eighth" shows la. "And the first of the fifth" is pa. "Then the twenty-seventh" shows ra. "With the second vowel" is ā, and by joining them it is explained as rā. "The first of the consonants": ka is extracted. "The thirty-first" is ṣa. "Joined" means that the two are joined as kṣa. "The pure twenty-fifth" is ma. "The second vowel" is ā. These two are said to be joined in the form mā. "The supreme letter of twenty-six" is ya. "The eleventh vowel" is the letter e, so that it is joined as ye. The passage beginning svāhā is easy to understand, so it is not explained.

"The first letter, finely pressed" indicates oṃ. This comes from the teaching "subtract the third of the second petal." The second of the ya group is stated to be ra. "Then the twenty-ninth" is explained as va.

"With the third vowel letter" means the vowel sign i, and so vi is stated. "The pure half of sixty-four" means thirty-two, and this indicates sa. "The syllable ra" is ra. "At the end, joined with svāhā" means that it is attached at the end of them all. "hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ is interspersed" means that it is placed in between. "It is the near-heart mantra" means the near-heart mantra of the Blessed Lady, the Great Seal.

Having performed the approach of the garland mantra of the Blessed One Jñānatilaka a hundred thousand times, one should apply it to the rites. For the Blessed Lady too, applying it to the rites and so on is as before. As for the retinue: for Stainless Sky and Candragarbha it is oṃ dhūṃ dhūṃ hūṃ phaṭ, and Surpassing Prowess, the Lady of the Left, and the others are likewise. So it is for the heroines as well: for the Born Lady, oṃ āḥ hūṃ phaṭ; for the Fearsome Lady, oṃ āḥ hūṃ phaṭ; for the Radiant Lady, oṃ mi hūṃ phaṭ; and the others are just the same. The rest, the mantras of the six wheels, the

vowels, the consonant letters, the torma mantra, the wrathful mantra, and the three beginning with the body vajra, are easy to understand and so are not explained.

This is the explanation of the difficult points of the fifth chapter, from the Lamp of Intrinsic Joy.

Having explained the stages of mantra, to teach the stages of the offering rite it says, "Then I shall fully explain the offering rite." "Apply the sequence of the sacred sites and so on" means that one first applies the offering rite to the sacred sites, the secondary sites, and so on. "The three drops, the divisions of generation" means the three drops of destruction, enjoyment, and power, in the three wheels: the wheel of great bliss, the wheel of enjoyment, and the wheel of Dharma. "Likewise the three of completion" means joy, manifest joy, and the joy of cessation. Or else, completing upward is what is called "completion." "Distinguished as consciousness and so on" refers to the four, the wheel of great bliss and the rest, and to the divisions of entity and so on. "The offering rite, the great land of Brahmā" is so called because it extends as far as the emanation wheel of the four wheels. "Consciousness" is the wheel of Dharma, which abides. "Appearance" is the wheel of enjoyment, which arises. "Space" is the wheel of great bliss. "Gnosis" means that the three joys too are applied like the wheels. "Divided by the eight bodies" means that the stages of outer, inner, and so on are divided by the sites of the eight bodies. "Distinguishes the entity and its support" means that all the divisions, joy, manifest joy, the joy of cessation mentioned before, the wheels and so on, are distinguished by their intrinsic natures, as water is distinguished from its sediment.

"Gathering as one wishes" means that all offering rites are gathered into the buddha jewel, and so too is everything, the outer and the rest. "The offering rite, the maṇḍala of yoginīs" means the assembly of yoginīs. "In sacred sites such as Oḍḍiyāna" means in the site of Oḍḍiyāna, in Jālandhara, Pulira, Kāmaru, and the other sites, and in the secondary sites and so on. "The goddesses, the Well-Pleased Lady and the rest" means that the goddesses too are to be distinguished according to where they abide. "The consonants, the supreme letters of gnosis, are given" means that one makes offerings with the thirty-two letters and so on. "The method to be practiced outwardly and inwardly" means the body, the channels, and the stages, as before. "If the offering rite is performed, the giving is great" means that when it is expanded, great bliss is attained. "An auspicious result arises" means the result of

buddhahood and so on, by way of its qualities. "Minds and the varieties of mind" means that the Teacher spoke of various methods according to the varieties of mind, good, bad, and so on. With the passage beginning "Methods for taming some," he taught many varieties of Dharma suited to the capacities of their minds.

"In this very life one becomes a buddha" means the body of great bliss, without remainder of the aggregates, which does not pass from this life into another. An example is the great king, the great lord of yogins, the glorious protector Indrabhūti. "Or else, Vajradhara" means the intrinsic nature of a buddha. "Or else, merely abandoning the aggregates" means abiding together with the imprints of gnosis. The unsurpassed gnosis body is like the sixteenth ground. "It is found by one without diligence" means this: if even one who is lax in meditative concentration finds attainment, what need is there to speak of one whose diligence in clearing away is unbroken? Everything he thinks of is accomplished. So if even the result, the gnosis body and so on, is found, what need is there to mention the other accomplishments? Therefore it is said:

Through steadfast diligence, all aims
Are accomplished by great effortlessness.

This is the explanation of the difficult points of the sixth chapter, from the Lamp of Intrinsic Joy.

"Then" refers to what is to be done after the offering rite has been explained. "The rite of worship" means "worship," and worship endowed with all its limbs is called a "rite." "Destroying all misdeeds" means that by its virtues it does away with all misdeeds, afflictions, and so on. "Captivating the minds of the gods" means that the minds of all the gods are drawn in. If one asks to what they are drawn, it says "flowers": they are drawn to these. That is why it says "with flowers."

"With the light of moon and sun,
Fire, lamps, and the marvelous,
One should worship the maṇḍala of the offering rite."

This means that one worships the maṇḍala described earlier with various offerings such as white water lilies and lotuses, and with offerings such as the five nectars. The passage beginning "The power of the first of the waning fortnight, by the first of the sixteen" teaches the sixteenth day, that of the waning fortnight. "Power" means that the three, destruction, enjoyment, and power, are the times of worship. "The sixteen" means that these sixteen

vowels are joined to each mantra. The sequence for all is likewise.

Alternatively, "moon" is the father's bodhicitta and "sun" is the mother's blood; from these two comes what possesses the light of intrinsic bliss. "Fire" is urine, applied to the meaning of intrinsic nature. "Lamp" is the great flesh, the very nature of bliss. "The marvelous" is excrement, whose nature is free of bliss. "One should worship the maṇḍala of the offering rite" means worshiping the maṇḍala of gnosis with the offerings of gnosis. "Of the first of the waning fortnight" means the sixteenth day, as before.

The word "power" indicates worship, and that worship is made with the vowels of bliss. That is why it says, "With the offering of arisen bodhicitta." "In the divisions of the waxing and waning fortnights" means the vowels and the consonants, the distinctions of gnosis. "Wisdom and method are perfectly joined": from joining these two inseparably, a wheel of this kind arises. As for "the three bodies," destruction in great bliss is the dharma body, enjoyment is the body of perfect enjoyment, and power exercised at the heart is the emanation body. Or else, each of them has three. "Gnosis" refers to the inseparability of the three bodies, or to the bodies abiding in the sites of joy and so on. Such an entity is called a maṇḍala.

"By days, letters, and mantras": "days" means the stages of gnosis; the nature of the letters is the drop; and the nature of mantra is method and wisdom. Because it protects that drop of bodhicitta, it is called mantra. "The hare-marked moon will wax" means that it makes gnosis increase. It says:

"By the drop and the cessation of space,
That intrinsic nature will arise,"

and so on. That which abides in the drop, the nature of bodhicitta, arises as intrinsic joy through the stopping of the gnosis wind and through setting out hūṃ phaṭ, emanating and gathering. If it is not so, even the Tathāgatas have not found it. Relying on the guru's oral instruction, one attains the supreme light. When that is attained, one is the very nature of all the Tathāgatas and the rest.

This is the explanation of the difficult points of the seventh chapter, from the Lamp of Intrinsic Joy.

From here on, to teach the rite of fire offering, it says, "Then, further, I shall explain," thereby vowing to explain. "The fire offering destroys misdeeds" means that by it all misdeeds are burned: it destroys the misdeeds that are

the conceptions of the five aggregates, the sense sources, the elements, and so on, produced by karma and afflictions, and the misdeeds that are the entities of signs. Moreover, it speaks of "pacifying" and so on, and the sequence of the increasing, subjugating, and fierce rites is distinguished by name and order according to the rites. The passage from "the fire pit for pacifying" up to "is triangular" teaches the shapes. The passage from "white" up to "in order" teaches the colors. The passage from "ocean" up to "is the measure" explains the measurements by way of the code of the fire god (Agni). By the two phrases from "no other is to be made" to "no other is to be accomplished," it teaches that summoning and the rest are also accomplished by the preceding ones.

"In each fire pit, a lotus at the center,
In the sequence of the families' rites"

means that the colors of the lotuses are distinguished according to the divisions of the rites, pacifying and so on, and each one's own family is set there. The passage beginning "That is, the crossed vajra" means that one meditates on the commitment being arising from the hand emblem, the crossed vajra, with light radiating from hūṃ, together with the wind, the sun, and the seeds of these three; one invites the gnosis fire god, offers him the welcome water and so on, and dissolves him into nonduality; and one should complete the presentation to him of all the substances, the offerings and so on. The divisions of outer, inner, and so on, the teaching on the sequence of the sites, and the characteristics of the filling ladle and the rest should be understood in connection with their context.

"The foremost practitioner, endowed with good qualities,
Greatly learned in mantra and tantra,
Single-mindedly devoted to mantra recitation,
Clear, his mind not carried away":

a yogin so described, who abides in the stages of empowerment and in the commitments, unstained by faults, great in wisdom and compassion, diligent in the meaning of what is learned from all the tantras, and diligent in meditative concentration and recitation, such a practitioner is called "not carried away by the thoughts of others." Of one adorned with such great qualities it is said, "This is a yogin possessed of wisdom." The worth of this person is also shown to be like that of a jewel, for it says:

"The mode of the drop is great gnosis;
Knowing its distinctions is the jewel family."

That is, one whose nature is to know, through the divisions of the drop and so on, the distinctions of the gnoses of joy and so on, belongs to the jewel family. "Of the five families" means the families of the Tathāgatas, Vairocana and the rest. "The young women are five" means five in number, twice eight years of age, that is, wisdom consorts endowed with the marks. It says:

"Delighting the mind, sated by the seminal fluid,
The long-eyed one and the pure one,"

and so on. That wisdom consort, moreover, is blissful with the taste of bodhicitta, her eyes darting and long, with few conceptual thoughts, her breasts full, firm, and soft, beautiful in her limbs and so on. Once she has been consecrated as the mother of the family, she is to be brought in for the sake of accomplishment. If one asks whether it would not suffice to bring in someone else for the fire offering, it is said that this is not acceptable:

"To accomplish the aim in the rite of fire offering,
The women of the five families are to be brought in."

Then, if one asks whether only actual women of the five families are to be brought in, the answer is no: it is those endowed with the characteristics of the families and so on. For it is stated in this way:

"Sister and daughter-in-law,
Daughter, wife, and mother-in-law:
Though they are taught as the mothers of the five families,
I have made clear that this is not to be taken literally."

"By the rite of wisdom and method, the guru himself makes the first offering" means worshiping through the stages of joy by the union of the churned and the churner, together with the guru. As for the offering that pleases the precious Buddha, pouring seven times with the pouring ladle of hūṃ and offering once with the filling ladle is done first by the guru. "Here no grasping is made at the conceived or the unconceived" means that this worship of the fire offering, as true worship, is free of any essence; one should apply this at length: one does not grasp at the site, the filling ladle, the pouring ladle, or anything else.

"For all whose own minds are devoured by spirits,
I have taught a variety of methods"

means it is taught that when the bodhicitta does not stay but flows out, and one roams among conceptions and signs, it is to be held by the particular methods. It says:

"Ultimately it is no outer object;
It is not inner, it is not outer."

The fire offering of ultimate suchness is not outer, nor is it inner, food and the like. Therefore this, which ultimately is not even the secret fire offering, is the very nature of intrinsic joy. "Dustless, utterly dustless, pure" means: free of the dust of conceptual thought and the rest; having eliminated all the dust of the imprints of aspects; and pure in the abode of intrinsic nature.

"Emptiness itself is free of non-emptiness" means that, in the sense of completion, it is free of elaboration and method. That is, this fire offering by its intrinsic nature is not form, is not feeling and the rest, is not the faculties, is not an element, is not the sense sources, is not the elements, is not utterly empty, is not greatly empty, and is not non-empty. Inexpressible and hidden, it is free of any entity of self-awareness; and this, which does not pass beyond self-awareness into anything else, is explained as the fire offering of suchness. Therefore it says:

"The aggregates and elements are conceptual thought;
The lord of the gods who burns them,
That, in the ultimate sense of fire,"

and so on. The aggregates, elements, sense sources, and so on are not entities of conceptual thought, as was taught before. "Horses, elephants, and so on" teaches that by presenting a series of gifts to those worthy of offerings, such as the master, one's aims are accomplished through the accumulation of merit.

This is the explanation of the difficult points of the eighth chapter, from the Lamp of Intrinsic Joy.

"Then, further, I shall explain" means "Without interruption, I shall explain, adding something more." He explains the passage beginning "The feast gathering, the great torma." "The feast maṇḍala": it is a gathering, because everything is gathered; it is also a circle, because it is encircled and pervaded by gods, goddesses, nectars, and so on. It is a great torma, for one makes the torma according to the divisions of outer and inner.

The gathering, moreover, is divided into four. What is taught as outer is the sequence of the actual maṇḍala of the guru and so on, and of the food, the five nectars and the rest. Inwardly, on the sequence of the channels, there is the maṇḍala of ḍākinīs and so on, and likewise the five nectars and the rest. Secretly, it is the gathering of gnosis, the gathering of the nectar to be eaten and the nectar to be guarded. That is, eating the fruit through the stages of the cause, and accomplishing the guarding, is the worship of the nature of the Tathāgatas and the rest. As for suchness, the two, the gathering to be eaten and the guarding, are this: the nectar to be eaten is free of conceptual thought about bodhicitta; or else, by virtue of that freedom, there is nothing for wisdom to guard. This is the gathering of the nondual entity free of cognition, by its intrinsic nature free of all elaboration:

Outer, inner, and secret,
And suchness, gathered together.

That is the gathering of bliss, the gathering whose nature is gnosis.

Having set out the divisions of the gathering: "The house, a three-storied dwelling" means that one should seek a place that is itself delightful and so on, and free of the dangers of kings, non-Buddhists (tīrthikas), robbers, and so on. It says:

"Not an outer land beset by every robber,
Nor yet an inner one."

"Adorned by the assembled masters" means that they abide wearing the bone ornaments, the six seals and the rest. "Plant the vajra arrows" means planting the four consecrated ones. "Surround it with the vajra thread and so on" means surrounding it with a thread of five colors, arranging the feast, and doing everything with mantra and meditative absorption: this is what the word "vajra" is explained to mean. "In such a supreme house" is easy to understand. "Make the maṇḍala with flowers and so on" means that one should make it as a maṇḍala of colored powders, or of flowers, or else through the stages of meditative absorption. "Varied and complete in all respects" means that, whatever the maṇḍala, one should make its limbs complete: the ornaments, the offerings, the gates, and the vajra fence. "Beautified with storax and camphor" means the offerings of the maṇḍala, applied at length, starting from the outer flowers and so on. This gives the divisions of outer, inner, and so on. "There, for the sake of the offering rite" means that one sets things out in the feast maṇḍala.

"Take the form that surpasses the animal" means that one should take a corpse free of the deluded nature of an animal. The passage beginning "of one birth" means: one born without interruption, that is, take the corpse of one who has come of age. "Free of all disease, accomplished in well-being" means the corpse, free of disease and discomfort, that becomes a cause for gaining accomplishments. "Fragrant, with dust arising" means filled with qualities such as fragrance; the true nectar flows, the very nature of bliss. "One whose eyes have long been closed": it says that the wise take it in order to make it nectar whose nature is gnosis. "With an offering rite of many kinds" means with a gathering of many offerings for the feast. "Examine it with a suitable curved knife" means that one should perform the act of cutting with the curved knife, extremely sharp, whose nature is wisdom.

"The lotus vessel of the finest limb,
For drinking, before the guru"

means that the finest among the feet, the hands, and the rest is the lotus vessel of the head. It says that when this is made into a skull cup and filled with the true liquor of the gods, it becomes the true feast. Or else, the skull cup is the root of the feast.

"Half is to be distributed to the assembly,
And half is to be offered as torma"

means dividing the meat, the liquor, and so on in halves. Apply the rest in the same way. "Great blood" is human blood. "Great flesh" is great flesh, that is, human flesh. "Whatever there is, is to be examined" refers to setting out the feast liquor and the other substances of worship. "The particulars of the various offerings" means that the offerings are also distinguished by the different kinds of food. "Provided with fish, meat, and so on" means that all these are present at the feast. "Without harm" means without having done harm to others. The passage beginning "free of all faults" is simply easy to understand. The passage beginning "There, the pure commitments" refers to the commitments of eating, the commitments of guarding, and so on, explained before. "Together with the wheel, the families are fully satisfied" means that, having satisfied with offerings the assembly of the wheel and so on, together with the guru, one offers half into the torma.

"At midnight, at the meeting of four paths,
Or where three roads divide"

means that one sends out the great torma at the four-way crossing where the ḍākinīs roam, or at a three-way junction. "Or on the riverbank of a charnel ground" teaches the place, and it should be applied broadly. "Not the leftovers, or else the first portion" means that, to satisfy the hungry ghosts with the feast leftovers and so on, one mixes them with water. "Set out all the others separately" means that one sets out ten tormas separately for the ten guardians of the directions. "Set out the principal one in proper order" means that one sets the great principal torma in front, and the later ones too are set out in order.

“Merely by going to one’s own place”: merely going to the site of a great charnel ground, or else to the bank of a great river, is the pith instruction. “For the circle, arrange a single vessel” means that the whole assembly of the circle should be arranged as joined together in one.

“For the master, a single piece;
With effort it should be guarded.
It should not be given even to one’s own group,
And likewise for those one has empowered oneself.”
This means that for the guru a skull cup of a single plate, without leaks or holes, is filled with nectar and guarded so that it is not lost. Moreover, it is to be kept unmixed even with the consort and others who are bound to one by one’s own samaya. Nor is it to be mixed with those for whom one has carried out the stages of one’s own empowerment and so on. Others say, “This is what is called having mastery over oneself.” That is an explanation according to the intended sense.

“If at that time”: since a yoginī may come there at the time of the great feast gathering, this concerns what is to be done. “If she comes” and so on is easy to understand. “At that time, laughing ha ha” means this: “To the ḍākinī who utters the verbal sign, give the mudrā of Trailokyavijaya, the Victor over the Three Realms.” That means that the yogin forms the gesture in which the two little fingers are linked like a chain, the middle and ring fingers are pressed down by the thumbs, and the two index fingers are bent like hooks; and at that time one should make the sound ha ha ha ha, heard throughout the three realms. Secrecy of speech, with “a little” and so on, secrecy of body, and likewise “secret” and the rest are easy to understand.

This is the explanation of the difficult points of the ninth chapter, from the Lamp of Intrinsic Joy.

“Blessed One, Wisdom, Lord of Victors,
You have taught this sūtra of the maṇḍala.
How is it taught definitively here?
Great Sovereign, please declare it yourself.”
This means that the Lord of Gods, calling upon the Blessed One Jñānatilaka, requested specifically the definitive meaning of the maṇḍala; his requesting means that he asked with courtesy and respect. “The Blessed One declared” means that he spoke to him together with the retinues, so that through this all would understand.

“The definitive teaching of the maṇḍala,
Just as it is, O hero, listen!”
This means: “Hold rightly in your mind, without error, what is taught through the definitive teaching of the meaning of the maṇḍala that you requested before! Hero, come to know it!” “From the meaning of the tantra spoken before” means: I shall teach here, condensing the meaning spoken above.

“The vowels and consonants, great bliss” means the moon and the sun, whose nature is the drop of blissful bodhicitta. “From the two, maṃ and hūṃ, the drop and the form are reckoned” means: from maṃ, the substance of the form; from hūṃ, the drop. That these two become the two hand emblems is stated in the words “From those two, the curved knife and,” and the two hand emblems also bear the seed syllables. Light radiates in all directions from the two seed syllables and is gathered back, and from this the Blessed One Jñānatilaka arises as father and mother, as it says:
“From the mirror of wisdom, wisdom
Arises from the melting of the essence itself.”

“A color like a fresh cloud” means, as it says, “His body’s color is dark as a cloud.” “Adorned with arms twice eight” means sixteen, from twice eight: eight on the right and eight on the left. “Terrifying, with faces half of sixteen” means he has eight faces. “Beautiful with four legs” means that being adorned with four legs is what is called beautiful. “Rich with twenty-four eyes” means that he possesses such qualities. “Destroying the darkness of the three delusions” means wisdom and the three powers, which embody the dispelling of the three afflictions.

In the passage beginning “white,” the central face is black, the right yellow, the left white, and the remaining one red. The others are blue. The extremely terrifying donkey face on top is the color of a bee. As for “the legs, left

extended and right extended,” this is called “four legs extended”: standing in the paired stance, he presses down Bhairava with the extended right legs and tramples the sun and moon with the left. That is why it says, “pressing down Bhairava and the sun and moon.”

“Skull cups with Bhairavī, filled
With blood, he holds in his hands;
The skin of Śiva is his supreme garment;
Those two hands stretch upward.”
This means that two of his hands hold aloft the fresh skin of Mahādeva, just flayed, and with the remaining other hands, having filled the skull cups with Bhairavī’s blood dripping from her mouth and elsewhere, he sports in drinking it himself. “The skin of Brahmā as a skirt at his waist” is easy to understand. “His body bound with the six seals” means the six beginning with the wheel; in actuality they are the six families. “In nondual union with the Great Seal”: this is the name of the mother, and it means that father and mother abide in the manner of union, indivisible into two. “Abiding in pure conduct endowed with dance” means that he abides as the embodiment of emanation coming forth from the dancer.

“Brahmā’s domain, ten million dwellings;
Brahmā’s domain adorned with faces”
means that he eats the great flesh and the like and is adorned with ornaments of human heads and the like. “The Great Seal, blue as the sky” means that the Blessed Lady’s body is blue in color. “Brahmā’s two hands, garment loosened” means that she is naked, wearing no clothes, with one face and two arms. “Holding a curved knife and vessel, with a peaceful face” means that she holds a curved knife in her right hand and a lotus vessel in her left, and appears delighted.

“With three eyes and hair unbound,
Embracing the neck, the supreme Secret”
means: she has three eyes, her tawny hair streams upward, the mother remains embracing the father’s neck, and the father too embraces the mother.

Moreover, it teaches as follows:
From hūṃ one should imagine a fence
And canopy of crossed vajras.
In its center, from bhūṃ, ten yellow spokes,
With the ten guardians of the directions and the wrathful ones.

Imagine Yama, black in color, in the east,
With three faces, six arms, and three eyes;
Vajra, sword, and trident at the right,
Lotus, hammer, and staff at the left;
His first two hands embrace his own radiance;
His right face is yellow and his left red.
One should meditate on him radiating from hūṃ.
Prajñāntaka on the southern spoke,
With white, red, and blue faces,
Holds a staff and a sword in his right hands,
A pointed weapon and a head in his left.

Padmāntaka on the western spoke,
With red, white, and blue faces,
Sword and wheel in his right hands,
A half-moon and Mount Meru in his left.
Amṛtakuṇḍalin on the northern spoke,
With blue, white, and red faces,
In his right a sword and a crossed vajra,
In his left he holds both a short spear and a conch.
Ṭakkirāja, blue, with white and red faces,
Sword, jewel, axe, and spear;
Nīladaṇḍa, yellow, with green and red faces,
Trident, sword, stake, and fire;
Mahābala, the color of a conch, with yellow and red,
Sword, noose, and horsetail whisk;
Acala, white, black, red, and blue,
Sword, hook, lute, and small bird:
These are in the intermediate directions, beginning with the sage’s.
Uṣṇīṣacakravartin, yellow, blue, and white,
Holding wheel, sword, skull cup,
And khaṭvāṅga, these four, in his hands,
Is on the eastern intermediate spoke.
Sumbharāja, blue, with three faces,
Faces blue and like the light of the sun,
Holding sword, hook, curved knife,
And skull cup, is in the western intermediate quarter.

All have three faces and six arms;
Their first two arms embrace the consort.
With the right leg extended, their countenances too are terrifying,
Bellies bulging, tongues curled, fangs bared,
All adorned with ornaments of snakes,
Beards and eyebrows alike,
Their tawny head hair standing upright:
One should meditate on the ten wrathful ones.
All of them are protectors of the world,
Endowed with the nine moods of dance.

oṃ jrimbha jrimbhā hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ guguro hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ dhara dhara hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ vidhara vidhara hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ tagheṭa tagheṭa hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ svaliṅga hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ aṭahasa hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ aḍha aḍha hasa hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ luhu luhu hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ vikrama vikrama hūṃ phaṭ
With these mantras, protection is made.

In the very center of its hub
One should imagine a source of phenomena (dharmodaya), like a kunda,
Arising from e.
The four wheels of wind and the rest
Arise from maṃ raṃ vaṃ laṃ.
From bhrūṃ, upon the wheel, oneself
Abides as the very nature of Vairocana.
Fully transformed together with the maṇḍala,
It is a celestial palace of two tiers,
Square, with doors and the rest,
Encircled by trees and charnel grounds:
Fierce, hideous, with jackals and the like,
Terrifying too, with the mouths of piśācas,
With laughter of ha ha and black fire,
Fully adorned by the eight Bhairavas.

The glorious flower, the eye-keeper tree,
Nāgakesara, va and ngang,
Pala and śara,
The kharba tree and śami: eight.
Cat, vulture, the sun-fearing owl,
Tiger, elephant, and jackal,
Dog, horse, and the rest, eight,
Hold sway over the charnel-ground trees.
Or else the eight beginning with the crow
Are fittingly explained as belonging to the charnel grounds.
The eight channels beginning with Kāminī
Are trees, since they bear fruit and flowers;
The heroes who hold sway over the trees
Abide each in their own nature.
It is adorned with such ornaments.

In the center, eight petals, red in color,
A seat lovely with the hues of moon and sun.
Arisen from the vowels and the minor marks,
Moon and sun appear clearly as two.
In the center the two seed syllables, transformed,
Are a lotus vessel and a curved knife marked with maṃ and hūṃ.
All of these becoming one here,
The Blessed One Jñānatilaka arises,
His body black in color, his faces wrathful,
With eight faces and three eyes.
The central face is black, like his body,
Then yellow, red, and green in color,
In order, circling from the left;
The others are like a blue utpala.
Vajra, bell, small pebble,
Skull cup and khaṭvāṅga,
Sword, and arrow and bow
He holds in twice four hands.
The crown of his head is marked with a crossed vajra,
His head adorned with a half-moon;
He wears a crest of Akṣobhya,

A necklace made of fresh heads,
And a skirt of Yama’s skin,
Bound with a belt of skull pieces.
His body adorned with the six seals,
He rises and proclaims the great sound of the nine moods of dance;
Pressing down the world with his feet, he sports,
In nondual union with the Great Seal.
Goddesses radiating from the intrinsic nature
Of bliss and great passion make offerings:

“O, characteristic of the very essence of the supreme body,
Where you abide has the characteristic of nirvāṇa.
That emptiness bereft of suchness is annihilation:
Do you not feel the bliss of nonduality?
Look fully on union with the Lake-born Lady in the vajra of speech;
Whatever is entity and nonentity, enjoy that!”

Worshipped and roused by the song,
From the intrinsic nature come maṃ and hūṃ;
From them arise the curved knife and the lotus vessel,
And within their centers the seed syllables abide.
From the melting of the essence, the Blessed One
Arises upon Bhairava, moon, and sun,
Surrounded by heroes and heroines:
Eight faces and sixteen arms,
Four legs, the right extended and the left extended too,
Three-eyed, his body black;
Three faces white, red, and yellow,
The other faces like the bee,
The top one terrifying, with a donkey’s visage.
Your body bares terrifying fangs;
Upon the body blazes a mountain of the fire at the eon’s end.
Having risen, he crushes the arrogant.
Adorned with fresh skulls strung on entrails,
His tawny hair and eyebrows stand upright.
The fresh hide of Śiva
He holds aloft with two hands;
His remaining hands hold in skull cups

The blood that drips from Bhairavī’s mouth,
Holding it in hand to drink and eat.
His body adorned with the six seals,
His skirt made of Brahmā’s skin,
With his girdle bound, he resounds in dance,
Laughing ha ha, with the terror of wrath.
He is joined in union with the Great Seal:
One face, two arms, her body blue,
Three eyes and unbound hair, the two embracing,
Adorned with bone ornaments and skulls,
With a crest of Akṣobhya the same as the father’s;
Naked, she devours everything in a mouthful;
Her two hands hold a curved knife and a vessel,
And her ornaments are like the father’s.

As for the heroes and the others who dwell
From the east of the variegated lotus:
In the east, at the site of Oḍḍiyāna,
Imagine Stainless Sky.
Jālandhara is in the north;
There meditate on Surpassing Prowess.
Pulirama is in the west;
There imagine the lord of the gods.
Kāmarūpa is in the southern quarter,
And the Lord of Secrets likewise.
In Mālava is Rock of Light,
In the land of Sindhu, Sun Goer;
In Nagara is Supreme Joy,
In Siṅga, Maker of All.
These are the sites and the near sites (pīṭha and upapīṭha).
In Maru is Utpala Essence,
In Devīkoṭī, Lord of the Great Field,
In Kauluta, Tamer of the Black One,
The Wondrous Hero in Arbuda:
These are explained here as the fields and the near fields (kṣetra and upakṣetra).
In Halikali is Great Renown,

And in Kutapa, Crusher of the Arrogant.

Meru Horse is in Lampāka,
In Kāñcika is Sky Face:
These are the chandoha and the near chandoha.
In the east, the north, and the rest,
The heroines are placed as before.
In the Land of Karma is the Moon Lady,
The Lady of the Left in Suvarṇadvīpa,
The Sun Lady in Kuluta,
The Wind-Eating Lady in Cindaro:
These are the gathering places and the near gathering places (melāpaka and upamelāpaka).
In the Gathering of Hungry Ghosts is the Coolness-Giving Lady,
Essence Petal at the water's shore,
Heedful Topknot in Carita,
Sun Tamer in the City of Youths:
These are the charnel grounds and the near charnel grounds.
The Peace-Sensing Messenger is in Kashmir,
The Green Diligent Lady in Ketara,
In Nepal the Lady of Seven Lights,
The Lady of Brahmā in Karuja:
These are the cat and the near cat.
In the City of Immortals is the Lady of Viṣṇu,
The Summit Lady in the land of humans,
Producer of All beneath the earth,
And the Land of Heroes on the summit of Mount Meru:
These are the union and the near union.
They are joined together with the heroes;
Their body colors and postures are like the fathers'.
Black, white, red, blue,
Green, blue lotus, moon white,
Deep red, like a blue utpala,
Gold, dawn, the color of collyrium and of smoke,
Cloud color, golden light, dark red,
Yellow, and so on, in order.
All the heroes have four faces and four arms;

Holding a khaṭvāṅga and a skull cup
In their principal hands, they embrace Wisdom;
The lower two hold a bell and a small drum.
With their feet they press down Bhairava, moon, and sun;
They are seated in the royal posture,
Adorned with the five kinds of seals,
And fully adorned in variegated fashion.
The heroines, with one face and two arms,
All hold a lotus vessel and a curved knife;
Their ornaments and attire accord with the fathers’.

On the second tier, upon variegated, spreading petals:
In the east is the Withered Lady, the color of cloud;
In the north the Fearsome Lady, golden in color;
In the west Stream of Light, red in color;
In the south the Lady of the Hanging Lip, green;
In the fire corner the Meru Tooth Lady, the color of the moon;
In the yakṣa corner the Blissful Lady, yellow;
In the wind corner Void of Reference, the color of crystal;
In the northern corner the Tigress, like beryl;
In the western corner Caṇḍālī, the color of jewels;
In the southern corner Form of Desire, of various colors.
Videha and Kuru,
Godānīya and Jambudvīpa
Are the path and the near path,
Where the yoginīs dwell,
Their faces sun-eyed, the color of utpala.
In Īśāna’s corner is Fire Face, yellow;
At the eastern gate the Radiant Lady, yellow;
At the northern gate the Long-Tongued Lady, white;
At the western gate White Dharma, the color of the moon;
At the southern gate the Truthful Lady, green.
In the eastern corner, four-armed, of various forms,
With hair and garments loosened,
Three-eyed, with ornaments of bone,
Most beautiful with the five seals,
They hold in their hands a sword and a skull cup

Filled with blood;
In the others, a khaṭvāṅga and a small drum.
The yoginīs stand on corpses with the left leg extended;
All of them abide in this way,
Endowed with their own radiance and with method.

The crown of the head and the top of the head,
The fontanelle and the point between the brows,
The tip of the nose and the two eyes,
The two ears and the lotus of the mouth,
The hide door and the throat region,
Likewise the back region and the vessels of milk,
The heart and the navel,
The secret lotus, the center of the sex organ,
The root of the sex organ and the anus,
The two thighs, likewise the two knees,
The two shins and the two feet,
The thumbs and the digits,
The whole body and the two soles,
The nape of the neck and the waist,
Likewise the Dharma wheel and the navel,
Likewise the fire wheel and the secret tip,
Likewise the hairline below it,
The jewel throat, the place of the vajra forehead:
These are the sites and the near sites,
The fields and likewise the near fields,
The chandoha and the near chandoha,
Likewise the gathering place and the near gathering place,
The charnel ground and the near charnel ground as well,
The cat and the near cat,
The union and the near union,
The path and the near path, and the rest.
These are taught as eight sites,
And the near sites likewise.

The wisdom being, abiding in the sky of intrinsic great bliss,
Is invited and drawn in with the mudrā joined with mantra:
Linking the little fingers like a chain,

Raise the tips of the two index fingers to the sky,
And make it firm by pressing with the thumbs.
Dissolving the maṇḍalas of the wisdom beings
Into the commitment being,
One should always maintain pride with this mantra:
oṃ śrī sarva tathāgata jñāna satva ātmako'haṃ
Just as water dissolves into water,
So the wisdom being is dissolved.
Then meditate on body, speech, and mind vajra
At the crown, the heart, and the throat.
Divided by family, the three wheels
Are meditated upon in the three places.
Endowed with oṃ āḥ hūṃ,
This is the commitment of the three vajras.
Since oneself is endowed with the six seals,
Therefore no armor is needed:
Wheel, earrings, necklace,
Bracelets, girdle, and ash, the six,
Are the ḍākinī of delusion and the rest;
I explain them as six.
It is also stated in the Great Seal:
As taught concerning the six seals,
The six sense sources are pure,
And in order they should be known as the six families.
The goddesses themselves are the six seals;
Therefore the armor is complete.

Then, the bliss of empowerment:
For the sake of empowerment, the Blessed One
Is urged on with rays of light.
Then those abiding in the sky of great bliss,
With vases filled with nectar,
Empower one at the crown of one’s head;
The stains purified, one becomes
The wisdom that is the nature of Akṣobhya.
Upon the maṇḍalas of wind, fire, and the rest,
In the center of the skull cup, the wheel of bliss,

Musk, the four-equal compound, sihla,
Camphor, and śāli,
The family deities in whom wisdom abides:
Stirred by the wind below, the fire blazes,
And they melt into the essence of the nectar of the five families.
By the light of oṃ they blaze fully;
By hūṃ the nectar is purified into white;
By a it is blessed as the realization of nonduality.
That substance, the nectar, should be eaten.
On one’s tongue, a lotus petal,
Set a white vajra arisen from hūṃ;
By this, outer and inner are fully satisfied.
With offerings of sun, moon, and the rest,
One makes offering to the body, both outer and inner.
By the yoginīs of the two tiers
The offering of the assembled mantras should always be made:
Between oṃ and hūṃ phaṭ,
Inserting the vowels one by one,
Beginning from the first day of the waning fortnight
Up to the sixteenth, one should make offering.
To the body of great bliss
Abiding in the places beginning with the forehead,
At the time endowed with mantras and flowers,
Without mistaking the time and the date,
By the power of destruction and enjoyment,
Through making offering to the eightfold body,
As Vajradhara, embodiment of the three bodies,
One attains the ground of the sixteen joys.
Then, with various praises,
One praises the wheel.

To accomplish every aim,
The recitation of the mantras should be made clear:
oṃ śrī mahāvajra genatilaka hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā
oṃ hrīḥ ha ha hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā
These two, the heart mantra of the Blessed One
And the near-heart mantra,

Have countless qualities.
oṃ vajra mretaye mahābala parakṣamaye hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā
oṃ sara visara hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā
These two, the heart mantra of the Blessed Lady
And the near-heart mantra,
Are supreme for accomplishing every aim.
Or else the garland mantra is supreme.
Having completed the approach,
One should then perform the various rites;
Through this all rites are accomplished.
oṃ dhūṃ dhūṃ hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ kruṃ kruṃ hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ groṃ groṃ hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ mroṃ mroṃ hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ jroṃ jroṃ hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ ḍvoṃ ḍvoṃ hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ proṃ phroṃ hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ sroṃ sroṃ hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ troṃ troṃ hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ droṃ droṃ hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ phroṃ phroṃ hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ broṃ broṃ hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ yroṃ yroṃ hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ hroṃ hroṃ hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ khroṃ khroṃ hūṃ phaṭ
For the heroes and heroines, twice sixteen,
The heart mantras are thus supremely taught.
For the yoginīs of the two outer rows
The heart mantras are likewise:
oṃ at the beginning, hūṃ phaṭ at the end,
And their names inserted in between.
a ā i ī u ū ṛ ṝ ḷ ḹ e ai o au aṃ aḥ
Or else the mantra of the vowels and consonants
Is the heart mantra of the heroes and heroines.

Then the torma rite is taught.
With jaḥ hūṃ vaṃ hoḥ joined with the mudrās,

The ḍākinīs, the guardians of the directions, and the rest
Are summoned, drawn in, bound, and delighted.
With the mantras of ā, kā, and so on,
And with the mantra found in the Two Examinations of Hevajra,
One gives the torma.
Abiding oneself in the nature of the wrathful one,
For the sake of protecting sentient beings,
Opening the vajra cupped palms,
One gives it fearlessly at midnight
And sends it off to the charnel ground or another such place.

Then I teach the purification.
Since it is clear in this very tantra,
I have not written out its details here,
For fear of tedium.
Or else it is taught like this:
In the center of the vajra tent and so on
One imagines the source of dharma (dharmodaya).
That which is the triangular wheel of bliss
Is the nature of dharma;
The bodhicitta dwelling within it
Is what is called the source.
Space is dharma,
And the source of the seed is the left.
Dharma is explained as the bhaga;
The place of the bhaga is the jewel,
And because the tathāgatas abide there,
This is the source of dharma.
The four elements, from bodhicitta,
Arising from the wheels, pervade everything.
The melting is the crystal celestial palace;
The rain too, in the manner of drops,
Is made beautiful by the four sides of the four joys.
By the four emptinesses and the four joys
It is made to have four doors and four corners.
Through the divisions of the archways and the rest,
The wheels and so forth are applied in the same way.

Or else that drop of bodhicitta,
Being of one taste with emptiness and compassion,
Is the four sides, the four doors, the four corners, and so on,
And likewise the aspects of the immeasurables and so on.
Thus to know phenomena as indivisible in wisdom
Is that very thing.

It is adorned with the charnel grounds and the rest:
Spreading all around, with burnt trees,
Half-burnt, crackling and snapping,
With all manner of severed limbs and heads, filled with hungry ghosts,
Terrifying, with garlands of blazing fire:
That is the secret of the charnel ground.
Or else, the secret is the habitual tendency of conceiving characteristics:
The corpse is the grasping at the wisdom of bliss;
With grasping cut off, it dissolves into its own light.
Then again, at the mouth of one's own jewel,
Blessed by hūṃ, it is the great flesh;
The heroes who hold sway over the trees and charnel grounds
Eat it and laugh,
Softly sounding ha ha.
Such a charnel ground
Should be learned from the mouth of the guru.
The Jewel Lady and Lotus,
The Great Reviling Lady and the Great Strength Lady,
The Great Head Lady and Great Intoxication,
The Great Joy Lady and the Great Joyless One:
These are what the trees really are,
Having fruit and flowers
And limbs, the trees of the channels.
The celestial palace is fully adorned.
In its center is the lotus seat,
Abiding as the triangle and so on.
Upon apprehended and apprehender are the seats of sun and moon;
From semen and bliss, the vowels and the minor marks,
Come moon and sun, and the seed abides.
From that shines forth the intrinsic nature of great bliss,

Which is called Vajrasattva himself.
This is the principal, the Blessed One,
Abiding in the middle between the supreme and annihilation,
And likewise between destruction and enjoyment.
Neither rising nor setting,
The Blessed One has ever risen.

What is called Oḍḍiyāna is the triangle;
The lotus fruit is Jālandhara;
Like Rudra’s eye is Pulira;
The family flower is Kāmarūpa;
Like Brahmā’s eye is Mālava;
Like a conch’s eye is the land of Sindhu;
Like the ear’s eye is Nagara;
Like a cow’s eye is Sridka;
Like a conch’s hub is Mumu;
Like an elephant’s navel is Dekauṭa;
Like the heart of an utpala is Koluta;
Like the heart of a lotus is Arbuda;
Like a bee’s mouth is Harikol;
Like a peacock’s mouth is Gautaba;
Like the mouth of a vajra is Lampāka;
Like a sesame flower in bloom
Is the place called Kāñcika.
These are the places of the heroes.
I shall now present the ladies:
The sesame flower is the summit of Mount Meru;
Beneath the earth is at the mouth of the vajra;
The land of humans is at the peacock’s mouth;
The City of Immortals is at the bee’s mouth;
Karnuja is at the heart of the lotus;
Nepal is at the heart of the utpala;
What is called Karata is at the elephant’s navel;
Karmira is at the conch’s hub;
The City of Youths is the cow’s eye;
What is called Carita is the ear’s eye;
The riverbank is the conch’s eye;

The Gathering of Hungry Ghosts is Brahmā’s eye;
What is called Cinta is the family flower;
Koluta is Rudra’s eye;
Suvarṇadvīpa is the place of the lotus fruit;
The Land of Karma is the triangle.
These, in their meaning, are the secret places.
Videha is the life channel,
Kuru is lalanā,
Godānīya is rasanā,
And the place called Jambudvīpa
Is what is called avadhūtī.
Places other than these
Will not be easy to find.
In the very nature of the eight places
One meditates on the eight bodies.
The site is the place of the great secret lotus:
The eight petals with their center,
And whatever dwells there, and their supporting grounds,
Each of these is called a site.
Where the intrinsic nature is born
Is taught as the excellent field.
Likewise, because genuine bodhicitta arises,
It is taught as chandoha.
Because the divisions of three, six, and so on
Gather into one, it is taught as the gathering.
Semen and bliss are conceived as two;
Their indivisible dissolution is the charnel ground.

Where wisdom is truly seen,
And yet that is no seeing, is called the cat.
Relying on the wisdom that moves from above to below,
Experience is the path.
Holding back the nectar at the mouth of the jewel,
Because it abides as the nature of brilliant light, it is union.
These, then, are the eight places,
The places joined with the eight bodies:
All Empty, Great Bliss,

Intrinsic Joy, Brilliant Light,
Great Rain, Great Wisdom,
The Great Seal, and Vajrasattva:
The eight bodies are by nature the eight wisdoms.
Or else, the eight signs are supreme:
Moon, sun, wisdom, and method;
The body that arises from these
Is worshipped with sacrificial offerings.
Again, following the sequence for the nectar:
Upon the wind wheel, the fire of wisdom;
The wheel of bliss, the secret lotus, the skull cup,
Endowed with the five tathāgatas.
By the Wind Lady and the Sleep Lady,
From the clear blaze of the fire of wisdom,
The five sugatas melt into nectar.
The seed syllables of the three vajras make it blaze, purify it, and bring realization;
It abides endowed with the three joys.
Seeing the nectar abiding
In the secret skull cup, one drinks it oneself
Through the opening of the secret vajra.
Then one should make the sacrificial offering with offerings.
With the flower of bodhicitta,
Without mistaking mantra and time,
Through destruction, enjoyment, and so on,
By making offering, merit increases,
In the places of bliss and the rest,
Or else in the place of supreme joy.
Destruction is the code for the supreme,
And enjoyment stands for cessation;
Between those two, one relies on the two powers.
Through this offering wisdom increases,
And likewise joy increases.
This is the offering of suchness:
One makes offering to the bodies of the eight places,
And those abiding in the near places too
Are thereby fully satisfied.

Then the heart mantra of the sugatas:
That is the bliss of the sixteen vowels;
Conventionally it is like the moon in water;
It is to be reversed and drawn up.
Or else, the proliferation of the wisdom of the three vajras
Is the sky of the Self-Aware Lady;
Gathered back, it abides in the sky of one's own self:
That is the wisdom of intrinsic nature.
That is free of proliferation, like space;
That is the ultimate heart mantra.
For the sake of protecting all sentient beings
The yogin gives the torma.
Since torma is explained as balaṃ,
ba is wisdom and laṃ is method;
These two are the supreme and cessation,
And their joining is the joy of cessation.
Protected therein, sentient beings
Will become buddhas, without doubt.
Such a great torma should be given.
Or else, for the benefit of beings,
One gives a torma such as this:
All living creatures one should kill oneself,
So that not even one is aware;
Killed and killed, they attain liberation.
This brings all migration to a halt.
This is the maṇḍala of the eight bodies;
Such a sādhana is hard to understand.
The maṇḍala taught as the body,
Likewise the maṇḍala of the bhaga,
The maṇḍala of bodhicitta,
And the maṇḍala of suchness:
These four maṇḍalas are taught as supreme.

Having thus taught the sādhana of the eight bodies, it is explained as follows. "Or else the heart maṇḍala is taught" means that it is other than the three maṇḍalas, namely the maṇḍala of suchness, which is shown below. "By oneself" refers to oneself, the yogin. "In order to take up bliss" means that a

special maṇḍala is described for the sake of attaining intrinsic joy.

“The syllable ma is said to be the petals,
The syllable ṇa is regarded as the center,
The syllable ḍa, the anthers,
The syllable la, endowed with bliss”:
the passage beginning thus is taught by way of maṇḍal, the Sanskrit name of the maṇḍala. It is the maṇḍala of wisdom, complete with the wisdom deities and the celestial palace, complete with seats and everything. Moreover, the petals and so on are the places; intrinsic joy is made the principal, and the other blisses are the retinue.

“The syllable ma is known as the jewel,
The syllable ṇa is said to be the knot,
The syllable ḍa is the long thing,
The syllable la is said to be the mouth”:
this is called the celestial palace of the precious wish-fulfilling jewel. In actuality, at the mouth of the jewel, together with the knot of the channel that links the secret jewel and the secret vajra, the wisdom of the tathāgatas, great bliss, is invited by wisdom and method from the expanse of space and abides there. As soon as he abides in one’s own celestial palace, that Vajrasattva, whose nature is intrinsic joy, is the wisdom deity of method. When he is asked to return into the expanse of space, he is the wisdom deity of prajñā. To show that the deity in whom those two are joined is Vajrasattva, it says:
“The syllable ma is the form of semen (śukra),
The syllable ṇa is the melting itself,
The syllable ḍa is endowed with light,
The syllable la is the form of bliss.”
That bodhicitta, having cut off all conceptions and signs, is the nondual intrinsic joy radiating light of many kinds. It abides in the lotus of the Blessed One, father and mother, and in the jewel palace, sending light out and drawing it back, in the form of great bliss, Vajrasattva.

“The syllable ma is known as appearance,
The syllable ṇa, the increase of appearance,
ḍa, appearance, the attainment of appearance,
la, the supreme, the genuinely stainless”:
this means:
“The genuinely stainless brilliant light
Is made the nature of the principal.”

Further, the three appearances are the nature of the retinue. From brilliant light the attainment of the appearance of wisdom is emanated; from that, as before, the increase of appearance is emanated; and from that, as the increase of appearance whose nature is wisdom radiates, the wisdom palace of the tathāgatas is completed. Then again, gradually withdrawing into the genuinely stainless, the essence of all abides in brilliant light; that is called the maṇḍala.

“The syllable ma is known as joy,
The syllable ṇa is regarded as supreme,
The syllable ḍa is the joy of cessation,
la is regarded as the intrinsic”:
this explains the maṇḍala also as the joys; the lord, the retinue, emanation, and gathering were taught before. Here, being joined with the wisdom consort and so on is joy; method and wisdom abiding as deities is the supreme; the indivisible union of vajra and bell is the joy of cessation; and abiding like space, having abandoned all signs and conceptions, is the intrinsic. Or else they are great bliss, melting, and so on, or from the navel, the knot, and so on. Moreover, it is said that the nature of all, the maṇḍala and the rest, is intrinsic joy.

“The syllable ma is called earth,
The syllable ṇa is taught as water,
By the syllable ḍa, fire,
The syllable la is the form of wind”:
this means that bodhicitta has the property of solidity: it is stable and indestructible. That, moreover, is because it is held together by water. It is ripened by fire, or it is endowed with warmth.

It flows down by means of wind; or else, as to its abiding pervaded by the wind of primordial wisdom, it is said:

“Because it moves, it is called wind,
Or else it is so regarded because it pervades.”

Someone may ask: “Are these two not contradictory, that what has the nature of the syllables in intrinsic joy is to abide having abandoned all marks and signs, and that the wind moves?” They are not contradictory. First, bodhicitta is set in motion from the wheel of great bliss, and there is no contradiction in its being moved by wind. Moreover, that is the cause, and it is also what is

joined with the intrinsic and with great bliss. Not only that: it sets in motion the joys other than intrinsic joy, and if the wind endowed with intrinsic joy were not designated as moving, it would remain like earth and stone, or it would become a one-sided emptiness. Therefore intrinsic joy is explained as wind. The wind is taught in the passage beginning “the wind of primordial wisdom.” Thus it is also stated in the eighth chapter of the later tantra:

“Wind is primordial wisdom;
Primordial wisdom is space;
Space is taught to be emptiness;
From emptiness everything arises.”

And it is said:

“Therefore, in order to find primordial wisdom,
One takes up great bliss;
The essence of primordial wisdom, great bliss,
Truly resides in the maṇḍala.”

Intrinsic joy, the great primordial wisdom free from all elaboration, is such that no one finds any bliss other than it. This alone is genuine and unmistaken. It is said:

“Unfathomably deep, without arising or ceasing,
Like space, intrinsic joy
Is called suchness.
The maṇḍala, the buddha, the precious principal,
The essence of the bindu, free of letters.”

The lord of the families of Vairocana and the rest, or the principal, is Brilliant Light, and Vajrasattva, free of all phenomena such as letters, is the lord of the maṇḍala. Because this is so, it is taught at length below, in the passage beginning “All aspects, without aspect.”

The passage beginning “Grasping at self is a great affliction” refutes the side of wrong views. Moreover, because the view of the śrāvakas differs little from that of the non-Buddhist Vaiśeṣikas, it is taught that it is good to abandon these; yet to disparage that view entirely would be wrong. It should be embraced by the skillful means of the conventional. Likewise, one does not disparage it at the core of its meaning, but because it accords with worldly views, though one honors it, one does not honor it.

“In the place of the single outer ledge”: this means abiding on the outer tier, where there are two ledges. “The yoginīs residing in this maṇḍala”: these are those residing in the outer place, as in the words “by the sixteen yoginīs.” “Always with flowers, incense, and so on”: this refers to the offering substances, flowers, incense, lamps, scented water, food offerings, and the like, and to the five nectars and so on. “One should make offerings with this mantra”: this is the mantra for the flowers and the rest, offered by way of being endowed with wisdom and compassion.

“oṃ at the beginning, hūṃ phaṭ at the end;
In the middle the name is to be inserted”:

this is the mantra. The vowels placed in the middle are the names of the yoginīs; inserting each one in turn, together with puṣpe, dhūpe, and so on, one makes offerings with these offerings. “With the oblation of the five assorted kinds”: since this is easy to understand, I have not explained it. “One makes abundant offerings to those of the maṇḍala”: one makes offerings to the principal mentioned earlier together with the retinue, distinguishing them as outer, inner, and so on. “Having made offerings, one fully succeeds”: through its qualities, one will obtain all accomplishments, such as the accumulation of merit and the accumulation of primordial wisdom.

This is the explanation of the difficult points of the tenth chapter, from the Lamp of Intrinsic Joy.

Having taught there the maṇḍala with its eight figures, now here only the recitation of mantra is explained. The oblation should be understood from the Glorious Flower of Joy. “Arisen from joy and so on”: mantra arises from within joy, supreme joy, the joy of cessation, and intrinsic joy; or else, it arises with the three joys as its cause. “Mind is said to be mantra”: this is easy to understand. “The churning and the churned mantra”: the union of means and wisdom is the recitation; moreover, below, the nature of mantra is taught, and thereby the fruit is found. “Mantra is taught to be nectar”: the vowels and consonants, the cause, are the nectar of bodhicitta; by this the name and the cause are taught. “The liberation of the path, that is mantra”: from the wheel of great bliss down to cessation is the path. Intrinsic joy, the indivisibility of wisdom and great compassion, is the great liberation, and so it is called mantra. That is the fruit of all mantras. “The expanded words are likewise”: the expansion at the tip of the jewel, the whole body being filled with great bliss, comes about through intrinsic joy. “It abides in the middle of the two

shoulders”: at the time of the union of wisdom and means, because the bola and the kakkola meet, it is called the time of sun and moon. “That is the mantra of the ultimate”: that cannot be expressed in words or letters; it is neither supreme joy nor cessation; it is the clear intrinsic joy, free of both the supreme and cessation. “Mantra is the vowels and consonants”: through the sixteen vowels and the thirty-two consonants, names are given to what appears as the essence, and bodhicitta is divided into means and wisdom. “That utterance is the recitation”: this means uttering the characteristics of all the preceding mantras; by this, recitation is taught. Moreover, it teaches the following:

“In the distinction of generation and recitation,
The recitation of mantra is well known.”

This teaches recitation: the generation in the three stages of joy, and again the completion in three, and, from the distinction of these two, the arising of the intrinsic mantra; that is the ultimate recitation, the recitation of the mantra of suchness.

“Where throat and palate, the two,
Do not stir”:

the place where the breath does not move lies from the place of the knot at the throat of the vajra as far as the lotus, at the neck of the palate. “That which is within the channel of life”: because within the life channel there is the essence of bodhicitta, the vowels and so on, it is called Brahmā.

“In forward and reverse order, the flow unbroken”: this means that one recites while drawing the crystal rosary downward in forward order, and recites the mantra while turning it back and drawing it upward again.

“In the three drops and the three pure syllables”: this means that joy arises in forward order through the three drops, and that the three joys are purified through the threefold completion.

“One should recite by one's own light, uncontrived”: this means that, setting aside the action seal (karmamudrā) and the like, one should do the recitation oneself, without depending on conditions. If one asks why, this is said with regard to being free from wisdom (prajñā). For example, it is like a buffalo, level upon the ground.

“With the tongue placed inside the palate”: this means that, through the union of wisdom and method of the two, the tongue as the vajra and the palate as

the lotus, the fire of gnosis blazes, and one imagines that, through its blazing, the bodhicitta flows down from Great Bliss.

“One should press with the rasanā”: this is the tongue, with which one presses and joins, as the great master will say.

“Or else one should touch with the part at its tip”: one imagines raṃ on the tip of the tongue, and from it a flame about a span in size blazes up; by meditating that it blazes within the palate, one experiences bliss. It says, “Through meditative concentration in the form of union.” That is, the mind abides one-pointedly, at all times, in such meditative concentration.

“Unproclaimed, like nectar”: this genuine bodhicitta has become the remedy for ignorance, the afflictions and all the rest, and it is unproclaimed because it cannot be expressed in words and letters.

“Then the way will arise”: this means that from that gnosis intrinsic joy arises, free from all stains.

This is the explanation of the difficult points of the eleventh chapter, from the Lamp of Intrinsic Joy.

The following comes from the teaching on the sequence of offering.

“In the two limbs, right and left”: when the bodhicitta comes downward, it descends from the left, and upward it turns back from the right. To show that it arises from these two, it says, “Be mindful of the arising of semen.” The drops arise one at a time, one after another, so that fifteen descend. The sixteenth is free from emission and movement.

“Of the waning and likewise the waxing fortnight,
When it arises through reversal”:
this refers to semen and bliss, the two that are sihla and camphor: the great bliss that arises from the union of wisdom and method, which is hard to realize.

“The nondual union of ten and five”: this means that between the fifteen gnoses, which are the nature of the fifteen lunar days, and the bodhicitta of bliss, any distinction into two is abandoned.

“Because bliss arises through this”: it arises from this alone, that is, it arises from the gnosis of the fifteen. Moreover, to show that it does not arise from anything else and does not exist apart from this, it says:
“Knowing the three realities, endowed with the ten,

Free from wisdom, great bliss.”
By realizing without error the three, joy, supreme joy and the joy of cessation, one realizes the fifteen as well; and that which shines clear as the nature of the three joys and the fifteen is the bliss free from every kind of wisdom. Others say that the three drops, as portions too, are explained as the three realities; that knowing them is the fifteen gnoses; and that apart from the fifteen there is no great bliss free from both wisdom and method.

Because the meaning of such joy, intrinsic joy, the sixteenth portion, free from both existence and nonexistence, is to be obtained from the guru, it says:
“Through the kindness of the venerable guru,
The nondual gnosis of bliss.”
That great bliss, Brilliant Light, free from the duality of method and wisdom and the rest, is to be known through the guru.

“It dawns through constant familiarity”: this means that by asking again and again about the gnosis experienced when the guru confers the stages of empowerment, and by growing familiar with it, intrinsic joy dawns.

“It is known through meditative concentration”: it is realized through meditation, but intrinsic joy will not be found through words.

“The form of the sixteen letters”: this is the essence of the vowels, the nature of wisdom, flowing down on the left. Therefore it teaches as follows:
“The drop of the vowels, in its own essence,
Arises also as portions of the syllables beginning with ā;
The gnosis of the vowels has the nature of bliss.”
That is, the sixteen drops of bliss arise both as portions in number and as portions in meaning: from the number, which is conventional and is the cause from which the bliss of wisdom-gnosis arises, one finds the meaning, which is the result.

“It arises also as portions of the syllables beginning with kā”: this refers to the consonants, the nature of method, flowing down from the right; out of the conventional, the sixteen drops whose essence is semen, comes the nature of the ultimate. “The gnosis of the consonants is great bliss”: since this is taught as the supreme gnosis, the gnosis of cessation is understood as well.

“From the union of the two, vowels and consonants”: this says that the two, method and wisdom, are given as illustrations, and through them the others are indicated as well. The sacrifice arises from that.

“One should perform the most excellent of sacrifices”: this means that the most excellent of all sacrifices are these offerings. Therefore it is an offering, and it is just so; thus it is explained.

“In the heart of the secret lotus”: this means in the center of the cakras, or else of the palace of joy and the rest.

“They are called the three secret realities”: the three, dissolution and the rest, being taught as the three bodies, are called secret.

“The divisions of dissolution, enjoyment and the rest”: the meeting of vajra and lotus in the union of wisdom and method is what, in the context of the sacrifice, is called the offering of dissolution and the rest. In the palaces of the lotus's abode, at the peak where the hare-marked moon dwells, is the true sacrifice.

“Dissolution, enjoyment and power”: this shows that it is the actual offering.

“It is taught as the three joys”: this says that the offering of dissolution and the rest is the three, joy, supreme joy and the joy of cessation.

“That is called the three drops”: the drop of joy, the supreme drop and the drop of cessation.

“It has the nature of the three bodies and the three syllables”: this is the offering whose nature is the three bodies, the Dharma body, the body of perfect enjoyment and the emanation body, and the syllables oṃ āḥ hūṃ.

“At the aperture of Brahmā, likewise at the neck,
And at the heart, the three drops”:
these are the places of the drops: at the crown of the head, the drop of body; at the throat, the drop of speech; and at the heart, the drop of mind. Or else, in order, dissolution is the aperture of Brahmā, that is, the Dharma body, and the other two are the body of perfect enjoyment and the emanation body.

“That is called the generation stage”: by this it is explained that it is so called relatively, in relation to the lower ones.

“From within the knot downward”:

This shows the meaning of the places. “The three drops of reversal”: one at the joy of cessation, two at manifest joy, and, with the place of joy, three; this is what is called the reversal from the three. It is also stated in these words, “Upward is the completion stage,” and by this it is clearly explained.

“Distinguished as pure cause and result,
The six drops are well known”:
the drops of generation are the cause, and those of completion are the result. Or else, the cause comes through the sequence of joys, and from it the result through the sequence of the intrinsic; this applies to the earlier and to the later ones as well.

“The stainless gnosis, as portions too, is six;
That is explained as the six unions of consciousness”:
for the six drops of generation and completion there are also six portions of intrinsic nature, and with them is united the intrinsic nature that is ultimate and free from conceptual elaboration. This is what is meant by “In union is consciousness.”

“In its center reality has entered”: in the center of those six unions abides intrinsic joy, an entity of bliss such as this.

This is the explanation of the difficult points of the twelfth chapter, from the Lamp of Intrinsic Joy.

“Through the sequence of the three tantras,
Six empowerments are taught for each”:
this means that in the tantras and so on, the three outer tantras of the Sage (the Buddha), the irreversible empowerment is added on top of the five empowerments of the five families, and so they come together with their results.

“The water empowerment and the crown”: the empowerment with the vase filled with water and the other substances has Akṣobhya as its result. The crown too, whether embossed in gold, ivory and the like, or on a painted scroll and the like, together with the generation, summoning and absorption of the tathāgatas and so on, has Ratnasambhava as its result.

“Are well known from the action tantra (kriyā)”: these two empowerments are known, by way of action, as the actual entry.

“The vajra, bell and name empowerments”: on the vajra one generates Amitābha and so on, and the result is likewise; the bell is Amoghasiddhi; and the name has the result of Vairocana and the rest, and so on.

“Are made fully clear from the conduct tantra (caryā)”: this is the tantra of both, because its view, and the particulars of its view and conduct as well, accord with the action tantra; so it is made clear.

“The irreversible empowerment”: through the declaring of the command and the rest, the result is endowed with all the tathāgatas, as before.

“Are made clear in the yoga tantra”: in yoga the four are clear, and these are known as the common empowerments.

“That is the empowerment in six divisions”: this is the division in terms of the results of the water and the rest. Or else, it is the empowerment that plants the seed; the division in terms of the cause is known as that of the master.

“The name ‘higher yoga’”: this is the name of the great yoga, the method tantra.

“The secret empowerment is declared the king of empowerments”: because it is secret, it is the secret one; it is renowned in mahāyoga.

“Wisdom-gnosis is unsurpassed”: the unsurpassed is the mother tantra, and in it the wisdom-gnosis empowerment is renowned.

“As for the fourth, it is likewise”: it arises from within those higher empowerments; as portions too, it is like the sixteen.

“The empowerments in their nine divisions and the rest,
On account of the result, become eight”:
the eight, the empowerments of water, crown, vajra, bell, name, the steadfast, the secret, and wisdom-gnosis, are the cause; and since the ninth is fully present in the preceding ones, the entity that is the result is also present in the eight, and likewise the fourth is present as well.

“The fourth is spoken of in just the same way”: this is easy to understand.

“Wisdom-gnosis is its result”: its result is the fourth empowerment, and it teaches this. “One should not know them as separate entities”: this is said because separate entities do not exist in the fourth and the rest, where cause and result are one.

“Thus it is called immeasurable”: this shows that the fourth cannot be gauged by measure or by reasoning.

“Therefore the meaning of the word ‘result’
Is the mind that is not reasoning,”
it says. The fourth, the essence of the result, is hard to express, and its being hard to realize means that it has left reasoning behind; this shows that that gnosis arises from meditating by means of the guru's pith instructions. Moreover, it is said that it is an entity free from arising, and that it illuminates.

If one asks, “In that case, the fourth, the intrinsic nature of reality (dharmatā), is taught to arise; so how is it that it says here, ‘of an entity without arising’?”: it arises from the sequence of empowerments, of the maiden and the rest, yet because it does not exist apart from wisdom-gnosis, it does not arise. Therefore it teaches in this way. Moreover, there is no contradiction even in taking it to mean that the ultimate entity, bliss, arises, while the conventional entity, semen, does not.

“Likewise, first of all, the sequence of joys:
In what way does it come to be?”:
here the compiler asked about the entities of joy and the rest, their places, their causes, the sequence in which their results arise, and generation and completion.

The passage beginning “Joy is known as action” means that supreme joy, the joy of cessation, joy and the rest are, in the state of sentient beings, what are called the three, body, speech and mind, and in the state of a buddha, they are enlightened body, speech and mind. Intrinsic joy is not found anywhere apart from these. Therefore it says, “There is nothing other than mind.” That which neither exists apart from mind nor is mind itself is intrinsic joy.

The passage beginning “Joy of body, at the place of the head” means that the joy of body and the rest are to be known in the places of the head and so on. By the passage beginning “Body is the cause; its result is speech,” one understands the later ones, in sequence, as the results of the earlier. Moreover, to abide having realized, with conviction, the joy of cessation, the essence of the wisdom-gnosis empowerment, is called intrinsic joy: it is the ultimate, unerring result. This it teaches as follows:
“Whatever gnosis is the self of the three realities,
That is the fourth, free from the three”:
the gnosis that is the self of those three joys, the three empowerments, is intrinsic joy, the fourth, which is free from the three empowerments and is the self of the three.

“It dwells in the center within the three channels”: within the life channel itself are liṅgala, ida and sośomna, and the center of the three is the Bird-Faced One; within it the result dwells.

“Pervading the three places, unborn,
Free from the three lights and the three existences,
The abode of Brilliant Light, the highest of the supreme:

That is the fourth, the supreme empowerment,”
it says. This means that this unborn one, arising from the three empowerments that pervade the three places, head, throat and heart, and free from the three blisses and the three kinds of semen, is the supreme, non-abiding abode of Brilliant Light, a synonym of intrinsic joy, unlike the three places: that is the fourth empowerment. Others say that the three channels are the places, and that the unborn is the fourth empowerment. The lights and the rest are appearance, the spreading of appearance and the attainment of appearance, and dissolution in the lalanā, enjoyment through the rasanā and power in the avadhūtīr; what is free from these, genuine and stainless, dwelling in the place of the precious buddha, is the essence of the fourth empowerment, so they say.

“There are two sevens in their divisions”: in this, the vase empowerments are eleven, with the secret empowerment twelve, with wisdom-gnosis thirteen, and so with the fourth; these are the divisions of the fourteenfold empowerment. Moreover, they are condensed and divided in terms of cause and result and of the places.

“Gathered in brief at the foremost of the limbs”: this is because the foremost of all the limbs and lesser limbs of the body is gathered in the head. By conferring the water empowerment, one obtains the result called joy.

“Conferring the secret empowerment at the throat,
Manifest joy, of supreme nature”:
all speech comes from the neck, and by conferring the secret empowerment there, one obtains the result, supreme joy.

“The empowerment of wisdom-gnosis,
At the heart, has the nature of cessation”:
from the cause, wisdom-gnosis, comes the result, the joy of cessation. Moreover, at its place, the heart, through the experience of gnosis, by realization and the rest, all apprehended and apprehender cease, and one abides in gnosis.

“At the center of the secret lotus,
The fourth is renowned as the intrinsic essence”:
this is the result, intrinsic joy, of conferring the fourth empowerment in the center of the secret lotus, the vessel of the precious buddha.

“Thus the empowerments are divided into four”: the divisions of the empowerments in terms of cause, result and so on are, in brief, divided into four.

“It belongs to the side of the generation stage”: since in the empowerments up to that point gnosis arises from one to the next, it is on the side of generation.

“The water empowerment is at the private parts”: this is easy to understand. By this only the result is shown. “Giving the result of variety”: this shows that it is the first joy, the result of the various delights of kissing, embracing and the like.

“It grants the result of maturation”: through the result of the secret empowerment, supreme joy comes from what had become the earlier joy.

“It grants the result of destruction”: having destroyed all entities, signs and the rest, it becomes the joy of cessation. That is the wisdom-gnosis empowerment. There, the bodhicitta becomes clear at the opening of the jewel, and the going of this clear bodhicitta into the space of one's own wisdom consort is expressed in these words:

“Because the mind goes to the lotus of wisdom,
The Wind Lady and the twice-born channel,
Through both expanding, there is bliss;
It is turned back by the upward path.”

This means that the substance of bodhicitta goes into the secret space, the lotus, of one's own action seal; through its going, it is experienced from the state in which both the channel of method and the channel of wisdom are expanded; and by drawing it upward through method, it is shown to be the result, intrinsic joy. Moreover, it says:

“It goes from within the knot;
Thus it is renowned as the fourth.”

The knot is the knot of method. “Within” is known as going inside the precious jewel.

“It is renowned as the result free from characteristics”: it is held to be the result of all phenomena, free even from all phenomena. Moreover, the passage from “the action of the knot” up to “the gnosis of the empowerment is definitively taught” teaches the result of the fourth.

If one asks, “Then are the results of the three empowerments not taught?”: they are indeed taught here, but since this is the result of the gnosis of them

all, the intrinsic is mentioned as the principal one; and the other results are not on a par with this result of the four empowerments that is sought. For example, it is like a king who, when his palace moves, sets out accompanied by his retinue; or else, if one invites the king, one's wish is fulfilled even without his retinue.

That gnosis the Teacher did not state clearly in other tantras. The passage beginning “In the Vajrakapā likewise secret” means that it is hidden in the Vajrakapāla Tantra and others.

“The meaning of the empowerment, done for your sake”: this means making its essence present for the bodhisattva Lord of the Gods; in other tantras, it is said, the gnosis of the empowerment is hidden.

“The meaning of the empowerment, done for your sake,
Is made fully clear in this tantra”:
the meaning of the empowerment that the Blessed One gave for the sake of the bodhisattva Lord of the Gods alone is clearly taught in the glorious Jñānatilaka.

The passage beginning “One who knows valid cognition, and” describes unfit vessels. “By the master who knows the genuine path”: this says that the guru who knows the ultimate path does not teach it to those who lack the fortune for what is higher.

The content of the passage beginning “By the syllable a” teaches empowerment: abhiṣeka means empowerment. Moreover, since the empowerment is made the cause, the result, the gnosis of joy and the rest, comes from here onward; I have not explained it.

This is the explanation of the difficult points of the thirteenth chapter, from the Lamp of Intrinsic Joy.

“Then, further, I shall explain”: having taught empowerment, it goes on without a break to explain the fire offerings, the inner and the rest.

“The fire offering whose character is inner”: of the inner, the secret and the rest, here only the inner is taught. “The mouth is the fire pit”: first, food is blessed as nectar; the cleansing offering and the kinds of substances are taught below. This is taught by “One should make the cleansing offering of jealousy and the like.” The passage beginning “In three pieces” is the blessing of the inner, the secret and the rest, up to “makes the supreme nectar melt.” In the secret fire offering, from the fire offerings that rely on the action seal, on

the pledge seal and on the gnosis seal, one attains the result of the ultimate Great Seal.

This is the explanation of the difficult points of the fourteenth chapter, from the Lamp of Intrinsic Joy.

“Then the meaning of the definitive teaching on the rite of the great torma is explained”: this means that the substances, great bliss and bodhicitta, in which conceptual thought and the rest have been slain, are blessed through the union of joy and the rest; in the joy of cessation the substances gather and become nectar. In order to protect all sentient beings, one sends it forth to a place: the great charnel ground at night, endowed with the taste of bliss that is dead and free of breath; or else the bank of the great river of utter joy, the place of the life channel, at the opening of the jewel, the place where the stream of bodhicitta is unbroken. By this all the obstructing bhūta spirits and the rest are pacified, and the beings of the three realms, with no obstacles arising, complete the two accumulations as supreme joy and the joy of cessation; and the inside of the lotus vessel, made of a single piece and very vast, is filled with the gnosis of great bliss. Moreover, the yogin imagines himself as Heruka and forms the gnosis mudrā, the little fingers linked like a chain and the index fingers standing upright without touching; as for the mantra for sending it, one sends it with balema and ha. Through such a torma one comes to find the result in which saṃsāra and nirvāṇa are not two.

This is the explanation of the difficult points of the fifteenth chapter, from the Lamp of Intrinsic Joy.

After the condensed definitive meanings have been spoken, it says, “Then the Blessed Lady, the Great Seal,” that is, considering that what had been asked before had been explained, the Blessed Lady, in order to cut through doubt, called the compiler and urged him on. “Called the bodhisattva mahāsattva Lord of the Gods”: from among the retinue of seventy-two kinds, she singled out and called the bodhisattva Lord of the Gods, an emanation body, meaning, “Dispel my doubt.” And she called him in pleasing and delighted tones, “O great hero, Lord of the Gods!”

“Will you not ask about ‘the nature of the three realities’ and ‘the definitive teaching’ and the rest?”: the Blessed Lady means, “In the first chapter the Blessed One spoke of reality and the rest; at this point it is fitting to ask about the definitive meaning.”

“The Lord of the Gods said”: delighted, he in turn addressed the Blessed One. From “Supreme Sovereign Lady” up to “the ends of space. Excellent, excellent!” are the words of the Lord of the Gods: having praised her for all her qualities, he says, “I rejoice.”

Again, “the bodhisattva mahāsattva”: that is, by the emanation body, the lord of the tenth ground. “Since the Blessed Lady understood”: the Blessed Lady spoke in this way so that the Lord of the Gods would comprehend and know.

“With a mind of great joy”: by the power of knowing, through joy whose nature is bliss, he sends forth many emanations and so on.

“Emanating miraculous powers, magical displays and marvels”: this is the Lord of the Gods' miraculous power of filling the world realm with tathāgatas; the magical display of emanating from each of them countless offering goddesses; and the offering substances, the many marvels he emanated, such as the flowers of the moon and the sun in the hands of all of them, which are by nature the lotus and the night lotus.

“Having made a sacrifice of offerings gathered in many forms”: all the forms, gods, goddesses, flowers and the rest, were gathered, and by making offerings to the Blessed One and so on he delighted him.

“The earlier question”: what the Blessed Lady asked. “He asked”: the Lord of the Gods asked the Blessed One Jñānatilaka. The Blessed One is the Teacher, whose nature is endowed with the conquest of the māras. He asked about the definitive meaning, reality and the rest; these are the words “Please declare it.”

“Listen! I shall explain fully”: he tells the bodhisattvas of the retinue, the Lord of the Gods and the rest, “Listen with undistracted mind.” That is, I, the Teacher, the Blessed One, shall explain; this is made clear as words of commitment amid the retinue.

“Reality born from the characteristic”: what is born from the dharmatā of all phenomena is reality. “If it is not so”: what arises from that very arising out of dharmatā is the essence of bliss, and therefore it says that it does not accord; that is, it is explained as not according with what is expressed conventionally. It adds this as well:

“Because it is of the nature of self-awareness,
Therefore it cannot be expressed.”

This means that dharmatā is self-awareness free from all conceptual

elaboration; words and letters of expression do not reach it, and therefore it is expressed by relying merely on the conventional.

The three natures of reality are taught by the passage beginning “appearance”: gnosis being clear, very clear, and, gathered under its own power, attained; and gnosis abiding at all times endowed with genuine light. That is the result taught by way of both example and meaning, and on this it says, “That is the gnosis of the supreme abode”: this is explained as the gnosis of intrinsic joy, supreme among all gnoses. Of this it says, “Its characteristic is that it is hard to see”: this essence, not found by analysis and not seen by looking, is not found even by meditation. This is explained in detail from here on.

“Portion, drop and mode
Are declared the nature of the three realities.
There are three wheels: fire, wind and water;
Entity, perception, own essence”:
in the secret place, in the place of the wind wheel, endowed with wind and channels, the portion abides. Above it, at the navel, in the place of the fire wheel, the drop abides, and the emanation wheel arises; in the place of water the mode rests. These three, and the joy of the entity called appearance, abide in their own essence. They are taught as the three realities.

“The mere mode is the moon;
The wheel of earth, that is supreme;
That is the perception of the support:
Lord of the Gods, understand this!”
This means that the mere mode, which has the nature of the earth element and rests on the Dharma wheel at the heart, abides free from stains. As for supreme joy in “Relying on the nature of the spreading of appearance,” it says, “The moon is supreme bliss”; the Blessed One, calling him by name, teaches, “Understand this.”

“Here the Great Seal is supreme;
Space is the perception of gnosis”:

This means that at the neck, which has the nature of the space element, in the place of the wheel of perfect enjoyment, the supreme abides: it is the joy of cessation, called the gnosis whose nature is the attainment of appearance. That is what is called the Great Seal.

“Its end is the supreme other;
It is in the supreme space of Great Bliss.
That is renowned as the essence of yoga,
The excellent nondual gnosis”:
in the place of the wheel of great bliss, which has thirty-two channels and the nature of the space of the other element, is the place like dharmatā, the supreme other. There intrinsic joy, called the discernment of the nature of Brilliant Light, is nondual with supreme joy and the joy of cessation. That is called “its end.”

“It abides at the center of the six wheels,
The essence of the six consciousnesses”:
the wind wheel with its six channels, the fire wheel, the emanation wheel, the Dharma wheel, the enjoyment wheel and the wheel of great bliss: at the center of these six is the consciousness of the six unions.

“The divisions of entity, support and the rest”: this includes gnosis and discernment. “There is a division into four”: since qualities arise in intrinsic joy, there arise the gnosis of entity, the gnosis of support, the gnosis of gnosis and the gnosis of discernment. Moreover, the entity is bodhicitta, abiding in the wheel of great bliss. The support rests on the end of its descent from the wheel of enjoyment. Gnosis is this: knowing it as twofold, conventional and ultimate, one knows it as abiding in the ultimate. Discernment abandons all the gnoses, abiding and the rest; expression, conduct and the like are found, and it discerns them.

The passage beginning “By the division of the nature of the three realities” divides it into three as well: portion, drop and mode. Moreover, it speaks of the ultimate by way of the conventional.

“Because it is free of night, day and twilight”: night is gnosis like the rising of the moon, that is, appearance. Day is gnosis like the rising of the sun, great appearance. Twilight, free from both day and night, subtle and selfless, where the life force and exertion do not move, free from all movement, has the nature of the gnosis of the attainment of appearance. These, too, have the characteristics of the three: mind, mental factors and ignorance. Because it is free from them, of what is called Brilliant Light it says, “The great bliss of the single one.”

I have not explained the passage beginning “Intrinsic,” just as with the one above. If one asks why, it is because it is the guru who makes it known.

Therefore the passage beginning “It will be found from the guru's mouth” means that through the guru's teaching one finds the accomplishment of intrinsic joy and the rest; and so it teaches that the guru is the nature of all buddhas.

The passage beginning “The lord and master of the ten grounds” means that such a guru too, an emanation body, a bodhisattva of the tenth ground, for example a guru like the great king Indrabhūti, lord of yoga, can readily teach the disciple.

If one asks, “Then can no one other than a bodhisattva of the tenth ground like Indrabhūti serve as a guru?”: it is not so. A yogin who has received the empowerments and the rest in succession from Vajrasattva, lord of all the tathāgatas, can serve as a guru; it is not that he cannot. Moreover, a scripture says:

“The vajra master's empowerments are eleven;
The secret empowerment is the twelfth;
Wisdom-gnosis is the thirteenth;
And likewise, in that way, the fourteenth.
To each empowerment one ground is matched;
They are the lords and masters of the grounds.”

Therefore, too, there is no contradiction in a guru who has received empowerment. Not only that, it also comes in another scripture:

“The vase empowerment is the first;
The secret empowerment, the second, is supreme;
Wisdom-gnosis is the third;
And likewise, in that way, the fourth.
By the divisions of the eight grounds and the rest,
Matched in order, empowerment is received.
Through this one becomes a guru, a master,
Able to confer empowerment on others too.”

Because it says this, he can serve, and it is explained that there is no contradiction. Therefore it says here, “Is there any other great Teacher higher than the guru?” This is easy to understand.

Having thus shown that the guru is the embodiment of all buddhas, from here on it explains that one should hold to the meaning of the mantra guru, abandon worldly teachings, and not teach empowerment and pith instructions to grammarians and the like.

“Whatever, in the guru's treatise,
Composed or explained, wherever it may be”:
this refers to the sādhanas and the like taught by the venerable guru, or else the sādhanas and the like he composed, or else any teaching whatsoever that may also serve as pith instruction.

“That treatise is the meaning of valid cognition;
That is reality, without error”:
“that” is connected with “whatever”: whatever teaching the guru has taught and explained, by whatever means and wherever, or composed, or given as pith instruction and the like, that teaching is the meaning of genuine valid cognition. Moreover, the root tantra says:
“Inference and direct perception, the meaning of valid cognition,
Should be firmly grasped by one who wishes for liberation;
Having grasped it, by meditating on inference,
One finds the ultimate truth.”
Genuine valid cognition is this: the pith instruction that the guru teaches directly, by his own mouth, is grasped through inference; and one who wishes to attain the Great Seal, having made certain of it, holds to it without forgetting the guru, and by meditating on it finds the result, the ultimate truth, the Great Seal. By that reason all mistaken phenomena, signs and the rest, cease; this is what is called “without error.”

“What the master has said and what I have said:
Between them one makes no distinction”:
the disciple who has realized the ultimate, a yogin with such a kind guru, knows and realizes that between himself and the guru there is no distinction in any respect. That is the meaning of the passage beginning “What the master has said.”

“Yoga” refers to the outer ones, known as the tantras of the Sage; the latter is yoga. “Yoga and mother tantras” means the method tantras and the wisdom tantras. “Whatever master composes treatises”: this refers to the teachings that have been composed and made.

“In that, as to correct speech and incorrect speech,
O Lord of the Gods, one should not examine”:
the words “in that” connect it with what was explained before. As to whether all the teachings that the guru has made and composed are incorrect speech, the Blessed One said this, addressing the Lord of the Gods. Things such as the

following are taught as incorrect speech: “treatises of poetry and drama,” that is, erroneous valid cognition and the like, which, unlike the teachings made by the Buddha, accord with the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) and others. With regard to these he said, “One should examine correct and incorrect speech.” “The treatises of mantra have been definitively set forth” is easy to understand, and so it is not explained.

Alternatively, “in terms of the four channels, it should be understood as aspect and the rest” means this: lalanā is going; the Bird-Faced One is suchness; this is the aspect that has the nature of the three; rasanā, entering, is caṇḍālī; the moon is taught as the measure of supreme bliss.

The life channel, whose nature is resting,
Is the very essence of the Great Seal.

Avadhūtī, abiding, has the intrinsic nature of the Non-conceptual One; at its limit it is free of aspect and the rest.

This is the explanation of the difficult points of the sixteenth chapter, from the Lamp of Intrinsic Joy.

Because the meaning had been understood through the earlier explanation of suchness and the rest, “Then the goddess was overjoyed”: the Blessed Lady, the Great Seal, was delighted. “Because the meaning of the intrinsic had become clear”: because what was explained above had become clear and been understood as the very nature of intrinsic joy.

“Embracing him tightly,
She greatly aroused the sublime lotus”:
she embraced the Blessed One in the manner of union, and, rising from the union in which the two secret organs, kakkola and bola, are stirred, she makes her request once more.

“The meaning of the charnel grounds and the rest
She asked of the Vajra King”:
the Blessed Lady asked about the meaning of the charnel grounds, the trees, the grass, the goddesses, and so on.

“Churning and” is the union of the two, with lalanā. The union of churning is moving again and again; it is explained as the union of method and wisdom. Delight arising from union is what is called “action.”

“The Glorious Lord, delighted, declared”: the glorious maṇḍala of method and wisdom without duality.

Lord of method is he; from union,
Delighted by the experience of gnosis,
He spoke to the Blessed Lady.

He spoke the passage beginning “The meaning of the charnel grounds and the rest,” teaching the meaning of the charnel grounds, the trees, the goddesses, and so on, by the division into outer, inner, and secret.

“Here, at the hub of the wheel of channels”: this shows that the hub at the center of the wheel of emanation and the other wheels is the life channel. “Endowed with three channels together with the life channel”: by its nature it serves as the support of bodhicitta and the life-wind, and lalanā, rasanā, and avadhūtī are the three that are together with it; the three abiding within the life channel is what is called “endowed.” “On the right side of the three-petaled lotus is piṅgala, on the left side ida, and in the center sośomna; they accomplish entering, abiding, and going”: the three abide within the life channel. The lotus of the Bird-Faced One, together with its hub, has the nature of three petals. On the right side, lalanā makes urine go; on the left side, rasanā makes sila enter without its coming out; in the center, avadhūtī makes bodhicitta, the camphor, abide. As the three, namely the Holding One, rasanā, and the Non-conceptual One, they are the heart of the secret lotus, which is endowed with the three blisses. These present the four channels.

“Entity” is the gnosis of appearance, associated with the life channel. “Support” is the gnosis of the increase of appearance, associated with rasanā. “Gnosis” is the gnosis of the attainment of appearance, associated with lalanā. “Distinguishing” is the genuinely stainless intrinsic gnosis, whose essence is free of conceptual elaboration, associated with avadhūtī. “Action” is presented as their arising. “Fair-faced lady” is an address to the Blessed Lady. “Is to be known there” presents those channels as the place where they abide, through the words “the gnoses there.” “Rising” is the state of enjoyment, supreme joy. “Setting” is the annihilation of bodhicitta, whose characteristic is destruction. “Time” is freedom from both destruction and enjoyment, the nature of empowerment: between the supreme and annihilation is the time of intrinsic joy. “Wheel of channels” means the six wheels, from the wheel of great bliss as far as the wheel of wind. “All that arises”: since the bodhicittas arise there, they arise in many forms. “It should be sought with effort” refers to the yogin’s seeking bodhicitta as the very essence of bliss.

“Because there is no arising from the channels, therefore”: this answers the question, “What harm is there in not seeking?” It is because, if one does not seek bodhicitta within the channels, one will not find the gnosis of great bliss. Therefore one must strive to seek it. “Of bodhicitta”: when it is divided according to the distinction between conventional and ultimate, it is summed up as two. “Nectar, the gnosis of bliss”: that which becomes the elixir against the māra of the afflictions is the ultimate gnosis. It is this that is spoken of as “entering” and the rest. This teaches that without bodhicitta one does not know the joys of entering and the rest.

“If one does not know, how will one find the accomplishment of the Great Seal?”: if one does not rely on the four seals, namely action, commitment, gnosis, and the Great Seal, which in substance are the four, entering, abiding, going, and birth, and does not find the gnosis of bliss, one will not find the accomplishment of the Great Seal. One will not know it. Therefore, since this is a fault, one should act. He said, “The lord of yogins who desires the aim of the Great Seal should not slacken in meditative concentration.”

Inexpressible, unborn, unceasing, the nature of reality of all phenomena, so utterly profound that its depth is hard to fathom, at the limit of the real neither rising nor setting, ever rising by nature, and become the supreme drop: this is the Great Seal. A yogin who desires such an accomplishment and applies himself to the meaning of method and wisdom, having obtained all the empowerments, will attain accomplishment by abiding with single-pointed mind in what the venerable guru has taught.

Because it was not taught in detail but the guru was pointed to as its source, the Blessed Lady made a request. “The goddess requested”: she made her request to the Blessed One. “Blessed One” is a call addressed to the Blessed One.

"What is the meditation of the Lord of Yogins here?" Since I have explained this earlier, I do not explain it here. "Blessed One" and the rest are easy to understand.

"From relying on conventional wisdom" means this: the awakening mind, abiding in the form of the letter A at the center of the wheel of great bliss, rests in the palace of the joy of cessation, and so it is the very reality of wisdom.

"One finds the supreme state of nonduality" means that one will find the supreme of all wisdoms, the nonduality of the conventional and the ultimate.

"By the supreme meditation of approach" means this: in such a state, as one's own awakening mind approaches it, to keep the mind's attention steadily fixed on it is supreme.

"One will attain the great accomplishment" means that by keeping the mind steady on that supreme state at all times, one will come to possess the accomplishment of the Great Seal.

"In one's own place, agreeable to the mind": this is the place of one's own joy, the place where wisdom arises, which is the place of the joy of cessation. "Free from all faults": the faults are the signs of the afflictions and ignorance, the basis of conceptual thought; being free from those faults, one is without fear.

"With a body that has given up rigidity" does not mean that the body is entirely cut off; rather, the body is not tensed but relaxed, made comfortable as one pleases.

"On a comfortable seat without waves" means: free from the waves of signs and the like, on a seat as comfortable as one wishes, at the center of the lotus.

"In the manner of being present in the middle of the navel" means that the self-arisen fire is present in the form of hūṃ at the center of the wheel of emanation.

"The syllable hūṃ is famed as the Great Fierce One" means that the fire, the self-arisen fire which is hūṃ, is famed as a fierce one, since it sets ablaze and burns up thoughts, signs, and all the wheels.

This is also taught as follows:

At the four places, the navel and the rest,
one should meditate on the four wheels:
at the navel, the wheel of emanation, sixty-four;
at the heart, the wheel of Dharma, with eight petals;
at the throat, the wheel of enjoyment, sixteen petals;
at the crown, the wheel of bliss, thirty-two.
The substance of each lotus is a channel.
At the secret place is the wind maṇḍala, shaped like a bow,
and above it the triangular wheel of fire.
The substance of the syllables is thought.
Through closing and through opening,
fire arises from wisdom and method,
and by the wind of karma the fire blazes.

From the middle of the navel a great light blazes
and burns the ḍākas whose nature is thought.
Then it goes upward.
It circles the wheel of enjoyment three times,
comes out at the right nostril, reaches between the two brows,
and travels to Uḍḍiyāna, the broad joint, and the golden circle.
It enters the nectar where great bliss abides
and partakes of the nectar of the hare-marked moon.
A stream of the rain of compassion falls;
entering by the former path, it enters between the brows.
Through the awakening mind it dwells in the place of enjoyment.
Burned by mantra, the ḍākas are thoroughly satisfied.
It abides in the middle of the navel.
Rising, it burns; descending, it restores.
Like a hundred-thousandth part of the tip of a hair,
its going and coming are hard to see.

"By stopping life-breath and inhalation" means: when the two winds of life and exertion (prāṇa and āyāma), which are joined as wind with the awakening mind, go together, that is great bliss.

"One eats the food of life-breath and inhalation" means that the awakening mind, that great bliss, should not be released outward but should be eaten within.

"Having eaten both life-breath and inhalation" means that eating them there, in the place of the two, supreme joy and the joy of cessation, is conventionally like the moon reflected in water. What comes about there? There, in what is like the moon in water, the nectar of the awakening mind fills the three realms, and so, being endowed with wisdom, both saṃsāra, which is supreme joy, and nirvāṇa, which is the joy of cessation, are satisfied with nectar.

"Then it contracts, and that is the sign" means: at the time when the moon is full at the opening of the jewel, the wind of the nose and the rest also cease, and from the place of the vajra holder the eight signs arise. "Signs" and so forth are easy to understand. Moreover, realization arises from the mind being steady in meditation.

"Then, knowing the Lord of Yogins" means: having known the stages of the meditation of the Lord of Yogins, the meaning is to meditate, without taking it

as an object, on the supreme wisdom of consciousness in the form of A. "By looking inward" means directing the mind, one-pointed and undistracted, into oneself. "The upper boundary" is at the hairline of the head, that is, at the fontanelle. "In the profound peak": the peak above it, where great bliss abides, the aperture of Brahmā, is the expanse of all phenomena, and so it is profound.

"In the supreme sky, space" means that this expanse of all phenomena is inexpressible and utterly supreme; this marvel abides in the sky of great bliss and is explained as having the nature of A.

"Having experienced the supreme letter" refers to the wisdom of realization that comes from experiencing, through meditation, A, the unborn.

"Making the lotus cave of Brahmā's domain" refers to the wisdom of great bliss, which is to expand the center of the wheel of emanation.

"One goes to the state free from attachment" means that this wisdom of great bliss will be known as the state of intrinsic joy, free from conceptual elaboration. This shows that it is the abode of all the Tathāgatas.

"The goddess should know that place of the glorious Vajradhara" means: it is the place known as the space of method and the expanse of wisdom; and as the Blessed One, the glorious Vajradhara, dwells there together with a retinue immeasurably beyond measure, he calls to the goddess and says, "Know this!"

"Of such a gathering place" means: all the retinue explained before, the ḍākas, ḍākinīs, yogins, yoginīs and so forth, assembled in the place described before; that is what it is called.

"On the ground of the source of phenomena, the great charnel ground" means: the charnel ground, in which breathing in and out and the like have been given up, is the exceedingly great bliss of wisdom and so forth; because all conditioned and unconditioned phenomena arise from it, it is the source of phenomena; and because it is the place of the birth, cessation and abiding of all, it is explained as the ground.

"Countless" means immeasurably beyond measure, even by koṭis.

"Yoga" is so called because it joins supreme joy and the joy of cessation to the meaning of intrinsic joy.

The meaning of "having obtained the accomplishment of the Great Seal" and the rest has been explained before.

From the Lamp of Intrinsic Joy, the explanation of the difficult points of the seventeenth chapter.

"Twelve finger-widths are without joints" means: from above the throat up to the aperture of Brahmā, twelve finger-widths stand clear, without joints or knots.

"The lower portion is half of twelve" means that below the throat, up to the wheel of wind, there is half of twelve, that is, there are six knots.

"Likewise in the lotus of emanation" and so forth means: as before, the knot is the secret lotus of the wheel of emanation, with its three principal channels, piṅgala, ida and sośomna; these three are the three petals of the lotus. It is this that makes wisdom clear. Concerning these it is taught as follows, in the words "within the navel together with the channels": it arises within, where the navel is, together with the channels and the lotus.

"The root, having come into the root" means: the awakening mind present in the wheel of great bliss is the root of all phenomena; that root, having come into the life channel, the root of the seventy-two koṭis of channels, abides in bliss, in the lalanā.

This is further as follows. "It abides close at the base of the petals" and so forth means: the life channel together with bliss, the Holding One, rasanā and the Non-conceptual One; because the three abide in the petals, the tip of the channel, bent back again in a single segment, is the jewel vessel of the buddhas.

"Endowed within with a fine aperture" and so forth means that the root of the life channel abides endowed with an aperture and with the three channels, the Holding One and the rest. It is also the support of the Holding One and the others, the support of the three channels whose nature is joy.

"By the nonduality of cause and result" means: the life channel is the cause and the other three channels are the result; and the joy that is the nature of great bliss comes about through nondual wisdom.

"The root and the fruit are sealed with the seal" means that by intrinsic wisdom all things, the channels of cause and result and so forth, are sealed with nonduality, with Brilliant Light.

"Endowed with roots, half of six" and so forth teaches the lord endowed with the life channel and the three channels; or else it is said of the life channel, which is three finger-widths long at the bird-face. The life channel is the

phenomenon that makes manifest the features, form and so forth. That in turn is the quality of the enjoyment body, the emanation body and so forth.

"Divided as half of half of sixteen" means: half of sixteen is eight, and half of that is four, namely lalanā, rasanā, avadhūtī and the life channel; these four are explained as the four, the Life One, the Holding One, rasanā and the Non-conceptual One. "It is a single thread of channel" means that ultimately it is one.

"Fortunate lady, the division of the three roots" and so forth means: or else, for the three, the Holding One and the rest, the result is also that very thing. Or else, at the place of the bird-face, within three finger-widths, the life channel stays without any knots. The one finger-width that lies at the tip of the three results is the place of both root and result; the place of the three, lalanā, rasanā and avadhūtī, is the life channel. The three, in their division into cause and result, are half of twelve. "The single one" means that they are all a single result. The result is the subtle nature, the gentle one, the Non-conceptual One.

"Up to within the jewel's opening" and so forth means: from the center of the wheel of great bliss to the wheel of wind, whose center lies at the opening of the jewel, there is the thread of the root channel that spreads the drop whose nature is wisdom, the thread that serves as the support of the six yogas. The six yogas are taught in the passage beginning "and also the rain".

"The glorious is not other; here it ends" teaches the name and extent of the tantra: the glorious Jñānatilaka is explained as the six yogas. Accordingly, of what is called śrījñānatilaka it is said: "the rain, and the manner of the drop, the mere manner, the supreme and the other supreme, the six, and the white mustard."

"This glorious Jñānatilaka" means that this, abiding as the very essence of the awakening mind, great bliss, is the lord of all. "Universal monarch of the ḍākinīs" and so forth is taught: it is the maṇḍala of the seventy-two thousand ḍākinīs and so forth, and these too are the substance of the channels, for each single channel is taught as a single ḍākinī. The "sky" is emptiness, into which the awakening mind goes; or else, all phenomena go into the expanse.

"Entering, abiding, enjoyment" means: the ida on the left, the sahi, entering upward and going above, is the abiding of enjoyment.

"Destruction is present at the place of going" means that the lalanā, musk, going downward, is the place of destruction.

"The element abides by power" means that the central sośomna, camphor, abiding in the center, abides by power.

"That nature is supreme, the other supreme" means that the nature of the Great Seal, the result of the three, destruction, enjoyment and power and so forth, is the supreme and the supreme of the supreme.

"Left" and so forth are easy to understand. "Likewise this is mindfulness" means that it is like left and so forth, or above and below and so forth.

"Those are at the center of the navel" means that the channels and so forth are at the center of the secret navel.

"A part of a hundred koṭis of a hair's tip" is the manner of its defining nature; it is thoroughly taught. "And likewise it abides in measure" means that up to this point, in the context of teaching the measure and the location, the defining mark is taught as well. "The fair-faced one, Jñānatilaka" and so forth are easy to understand.

"The lord of all those grounds, the master" means that the lord of the sixteen grounds is the Blessed One, the glorious Jñānatilaka, the Great Lord (Maheśvara).

"The places and the rest are places of joy" means that the sixteen, the place (pīṭha), the near-place (upapīṭha) and so forth, are correlated with the sixteen joys. "It is expressed by the word ground" means that they are also correlated with the sixteen beginning with the ground of conduct through devotion. If one asks how they are correlated, they are correlated in the order of the place, the near-place and so forth. This too is taught as follows:

By dividing in order the place and the rest,
joy and the rest are divided in order;
such is the division of the grounds.

The place, the joy of desire, the ground of conduct through devotion;
the near-place, the joy of trembling, the ground of Supreme Joy;
the field, the joy of going, the Stainless ground;
the near-field, the joyful one, the Luminous;
the chandoha, the joy of expansion, the Radiant;
the near-chandoha, the joy of māra, the Hard to Conquer;
the assembly, the joy of arising, the Manifest;
the near-assembly, supreme joy, the Gone Far;
the charnel ground, the joy of blazing, the Immovable;

the near-assembly, the joy of the drop, Good Intelligence;
the pīlava, the joy of inclination, the ground Cloud of Dharma;
the near-pīlava, the joy of cessation, Coming Everywhere;
the path, the joy of ut, All Appearance Spreading;
the near one, the joy of the manner, Attainment of Appearance;
union, the joy of the two, the ground of Brilliant Light;
near-union, the intrinsic, the Inexpressible.
By the divisions of the place and the rest,
join the joys and the grounds, distinguishing them.

So it says. These are correlated at greater length as well. The ground of conduct through devotion is the ground endowed with heat, peak, forbearance and the highest worldly phenomenon; it is the first. It is the result of the water empowerment.

From the Lamp of Intrinsic Joy, the explanation of the difficult points of the eighteenth chapter.

When the measure of the tantra and so forth had been taught, the Blessed Lady made a request, in order to connect master and disciple, and because the order of the tantras had not been stated above. "Then again it is to be explained" means that, as soon as she had asked, he consented to explain, that is, "although it was taught above". "The characteristics of the guru and the disciple" and so forth are the characteristics of the relationship between the two; first, the qualities of the guru are taught. "Other" and so forth means: one who has obtained the divisions of the vase empowerment and so forth, the secret empowerment, the wisdom-knowledge empowerment and the fourth empowerment and so forth, up to the empowerment of intention; who has compassion for sentient beings; who is magnificent through the conduct of mantra and the like and adorned with every quality: such a guru is Vajrasattva in person. The disciple, too, should be accepted as one likewise complete in qualities.

From the Lamp of Intrinsic Joy, the explanation of the difficult points of the nineteenth chapter.

Having explained the characteristics of the master and so forth, he explains the order of the tantras together with their meaning. "Like a sprout from a seed" means: just as the sprout comes from the seed and the stem from that, so from the root tantra comes the tantra of examination, from that the later

tantra, from that the later of the later, from that the explanatory tantra, from that the essence tantra, from that the fruit tantra, and from that the wondrous tantra. "All the tantras in order" means that, by knowing the earlier tantra in this way, one knows the others as well; this order, the connection, is what is explained as tantra.

"Or else, the meaning is tantra" means: because the meaning of Vajrasattva is indicated by words and letters, the connection is called tantra; or else, expressing the meaning of Vajrasattva is called, as before, holding the tantra. "Or else, the two stages are tantra" means the connection whereby, having entered by way of the generation stage, one attains the completion stage. The goddess is addressed by name and it is explained to her.

"Where, fortunate lady" refers to the ground where they abide at one time, as in: "The ground where wisdom and method meet is explained as tantra." This means: from the churning of father and mother, the meeting of moon and sun; what is fortunate is that all the Tathāgatas become once more of the single family of Vajradhara, and this is explained as tantra.

"Or else, arising from wisdom" and so forth means: tantra is continuum. Father and mother, having perfected the bodies of the deities and abandoned the stains of ordinary thought and the like, from the mingling of the substances of moon and sun, from the aspect of that joy of cessation, there is intrinsic joy, which is ultimately free from signs and the like and conventionally abides like the full moon reflected in water: this is the meaning of A. Why? A is without arising and ceasing, and what has no arising and ceasing is called the ultimate. As the Litany of Names says:

A is the supreme of all syllables,
arising from within, unborn.

Scripture also teaches this:

A is at ease in the sphere of space,
abandoning all expression;
it is not ceasing, not arising,
nor is it free from both arising and ceasing.

By this the meaning of the tantra of the sacred way is also explained.

From the Lamp of Intrinsic Joy, the explanation of the difficult points of the twentieth chapter.

Since it was taught that what is called tantra is the father and mother, the Blessed Lady asked what her own nature is and what the tantra is. "Blessed One" and so forth means: although it is taught, its meaning is likewise hard to realize; it is the practitioner endowed with genuine wisdom who finds the Blessed Lady.

"Goddess, you do not arise" and so forth means: she does not arise even from a cause, is not born from one thing into another, and does not pass from above to below; she is the vast one, free from such phenomena as the signs of birth and death.

"Your own nature is the light of wisdom" and so forth means: it is the light of the Blessed One Jñānatilaka taught earlier, and therefore it is called the wisdom of one's own light. When this is divided into the conventional and the ultimate, it is the division together with one's own wisdom, outer and so forth.

"If there were not I and you, no other" and so forth means: if there were not the two, father and mother, it would be hard to find even for the Tathāgatas, and there would be the fault that the whole world would obtain the unsurpassed fruit. Therefore it says, "like a man whose head has been cut off." Knowing it to be like the qualities of omniscience, the fact that sentient beings in this way find the fruit of Vajradhara is also declared to be a quality of the goddess.

Although this is so ultimately, "In the conventional generation stage, she comes from the place of supreme space" and so forth means: she comes from the space of the supreme and special wheel of great bliss, goes to the wheel of complete enjoyment, and abides in the wheel of Dharma. Then she dwells at all times in the wheel of emanation. Great bliss, the awakening mind, is the cause; enjoyment is the source from which it arises; Dharma is the support in which it abides; and emanation is the basis of its nature.

"In the conventional form of aspects" and so forth means that, from the conventional, the wisdom body of the ultimate dwells in the core of the secret tip, in the manner of the father's awakening mind and the mother's awakening mind.

"When it rises, the lotus is bliss, because the drop is taken within" means: in order to realize and find the drop of the nondual awakening mind, through the union of method and wisdom, from the fire kindled by the wind it rises and blazes in the wheel of emanation.

"Having gone, it burns all that rely on it" means that, as the light of caṇḍālī goes upward from the navel, it burns all the aggregates, elements and so forth that are the substances of thought in the wheel of Dharma.

"Carrying the drop of the Victor" means that, by the light of the Tathāgata, entering from the wheel of enjoyment and so forth into the golden gate, it delights in the nectar of great bliss and then descends again by the former path.

"And again, the purpose of your coming here" refers to its being given, together with method, to the vessel, one's own lotus. On this it is taught as follows: what was burned up to the wheel of Dharma is restored and abides in the middle of the wheel of emanation at the navel. "At that time" and so forth are easy to understand.

From the Lamp of Intrinsic Joy, the explanation of the difficult points of the twenty-first chapter.

Having taught the very nature of the Great Seal, he explains further. "The awakening mind is the secret": the secret is explained as threefold, divided by its superior, middling and inferior meanings. In this context, the awakening mind as semen is taught as the secret. "The nature of semen is free from flying off" and so forth means that this semen, free from going, transferring and the like, abiding in the bhaga of wisdom and abiding also in all sentient beings, is the thing that brings about the experience of joy.

"The Blessed Lady requested" and so forth means that she asked the Blessed One again, raising an objection: if the semen form of the awakening mind is the secret, then since all the sentient beings of the three realms know that secret, there would be the fault that they would be liberated without any need for the vase empowerment, the secret empowerment and the rest to be conferred.

"The Blessed One declared" means that he replied again to the goddess. "Mother of the buddhas, that is true" and so forth means: the mother who gives birth to the five families of the Tathāgatas and so forth is the awakening mind, the secret, which is semen; take this as certain, without error. "However" means that, although it is so, it is divided in two, the provisional meaning and the definitive meaning. Thus, "It is endowed with words of provisional meaning" means: because it is treated as provisional meaning, when it arises through being stated in words, it is endowed with both word and meaning.

"For the sake of the support, the genuine definitive meaning; without the support the fruit will not be found" means: although relying on the secret, the semen form of the awakening mind, is the provisional meaning, through the definitive meaning one finds the wisdom of bliss; and without the support, the nature of semen, one does not find the fruit, definitive wisdom.

"Just as without the body there is no mind here, so the meaning agrees: the secret" means: just as, for example, without a body there is no abiding of mind, so, like that example, without semen there is no bliss; the meaning agrees.

Now, in the four spheres there is the formless realm; therefore the teaching is a teaching of desire. If one objects, "Semen as form is the body; is it not contradictory that the mind of bliss should be in it?", that is true as you say; nevertheless, as in the example that the substance of fragrance does not arise without the form of a flower, the teaching is not given with respect to the formless realm but with respect to those of the desire realm. By this the inferior secret is taught.

"Neither provisional meaning nor definitive meaning" and so forth teaches the secret of the ultimate completion, free from the conventional generation stage: the superior secret.

"Or else, by the middling meaning" and so forth is the middling secret; through it one will find intrinsic joy, the superior secret. What one finds is inexpressible, the very nature of space.

From the Lamp of Intrinsic Joy, the explanation of the difficult points of the twenty-second chapter.

Because the Blessed One had called the secret meaning intrinsic joy, the Blessed Lady, thinking that when the intrinsic nature is realized it is the ultimate root of all phenomena, made her request, as in "Then the Blessed Lady, in a gentle voice, again made a request" and so forth. Speaking in a sweet and gentle voice, "Blessed One, Vajrasattva, protector who has become the protector of the protectorless," she asked, "What is intrinsic joy, the meaning by which you previously established all phenomena?" It was the goddess who asked.

"Having heard such words" means: having heard the words "What is the nature of that ultimate intrinsic joy, free from conceptual elaboration?", the Blessed One, as in "remaining silent" and so forth, entered into the meaning of

intrinsic joy and remained so. Why? The meaning of intrinsic joy is freed from the two, supreme joy and the joy of cessation; it is free from words, free from letters, and has abandoned cause and result. It is like this:

Without exhaustion and without increase,
without arising and without ceasing,
without coming and without going,
without transferring and without abiding;
it is not the beginning, not the end,
it is not the middle, nor the extreme;
it is not nirvāṇa, not saṃsāra,
it is not grasped, nor is it grasping.
This absorption of wisdom and method:
all things are gathered into it.
The Lord of Yogins knows the time;
free from time is the intrinsic meaning.
Such an intrinsic nature, the ultimate,
has no rising and no setting.
The time when the two are joined
is explained as intrinsic joy.

So it says. The passage from "Then the Blessed Lady" up to "remained without speaking at all" shows her regret at having asked about the intrinsic meaning. The passage from "at that time" to "appeared in variety," "existing," and so forth, means that the Blessed Lady with her retinue saw, within the variegated lotus, the source of phenomena as empty, and so on. Here "variegated" is the assembly together with the retinue. "Lotus" is the expanse of the nature of reality, unborn and free from faults. The source of phenomena was explained before. "Empty" and the rest are not explained because they are easy to understand.

"O bodhisattvas" and so forth is the question put by the Blessed Lady with her retinue. "By the Lord of the Gods" and so forth is easy to understand. As for "Why? Because the intrinsic is inexpressible" and so forth, its meaning was explained before.

"Because there is no awareness, there is no answer to the question": although this was taught before, here, since the request was "Teach what cannot be taught, where there is nothing to be known, nothing to be cognized, nothing to be realized," there is no answer, and so it is explained that "he remained."

If one asks how intrinsic joy, by way of example, is without appearance, and how it is nonetheless experienced conventionally: intrinsic joy, like space, has no appearance, for it is free from all appearances. Its experience is conventionally like, for example, the exceedingly full bliss of a girl who has reached sixteen years. As scripture says:

Like the passionate joy of the young,
like the dream of a mute,
the eye is sealed by suchness itself:
this intrinsic nature is exceedingly subtle.

It is also taught as follows:

"Realize!" When one thoroughly realizes,
what becomes clear is the fourth.
The essence of wisdom is exceedingly subtle;
Vajrasattva is equal to space.

By this one finds the meaning of intrinsic joy, which is not anything at all.

From the Lamp of Intrinsic Joy, the explanation of the difficult points of the twenty-third chapter.

The rest will be explained by the guru; and since there is no fruit other than intrinsic joy, the root of all, which is like a precious jewel, they are not explained. Therefore it is condensed here.

Whatever the summary of intrinsic joy may be,
the one who knows it is the Lord of Yogins.
That I have explained clearly;
I beg the forbearance of the ḍākinīs of the intrinsic.
The yogin who has obtained the four empowerments,
distinguishing them as explained in their context,
should seek the fruit of the four joys;
I beg the forbearance of the four ḍākinīs.
Though these are words like those of a madman,
since a meaning like mindfulness arises,
of the gurus, who are like buddhas,
I beg a forbearance that is like illusion.
This jewel of intrinsic joy
has been made clear by the lamp of wisdom.
Like one who finds it and is freed from poverty,

may it become the jewel of all sentient beings.
By the virtue of my composing
this commentary on the difficult points of the Lamp of Intrinsic Joy,
may it become a lamp of wisdom for the three realms,
and may they find the intrinsic meaning.

The commentary on the difficult points called the Glorious Lamp of Intrinsic Joy, a condensation of its essential meaning, composed by the great master Vajraguhya, is complete.

It was translated and explained by the Indian preceptor, the great yogin Śrī Prajñāgupta.

This jewel-like commentary
is entrusted to a son who is a fit vessel.
From those without empowerment, who are like darkness,
keep it bound with a mind like an iron hook.

These are the words of entrustment, together with the rite.

Translator's Notes

• The opening verse pairs wisdom with "the sky" and gnosis with "the going"; in Tibetan the two words together make mkha' 'gro, "sky-goer," the word for ḍāka and ḍākinī, so 'gro ba is rendered "going" rather than "beings," and their nonduality is the "lord." "Jewel-stealing ladies" renders rin chen phrog ma literally; the term behind it could not be securely identified. "The four syllables" are e, vaṃ, ma, yā of the Sanskrit evaṃ mayā, "Thus did I." In the verse on the letter a, dgyes ("delights") is read as gyes ("branch out"), which the contrast with "gather back into one" requires. The compiler's name, lha'i dbang phyug, is translated "Lord of Gods," as the commentary itself explains it; its Sanskrit form could not be identified with confidence. The names quoted from the root tantra's lists of heroes and heroines are likewise translated literally (Stainless Sky, Sky Face, Desire-Form Lady) or kept as spelled (Lāmā, Marata). Mtshan in this passage is the honorific word for "name," not the major marks. In the verse on the bodhisattva the Tibetan accidentally repeats a line and a half; the verse is translated once. "Seventy-two classes" (bye brag) of ḍākinīs may be a slip for the "seventy-two koṭis" (bye ba phrag) given elsewhere in the passage. Rin po'i che'i is read as rin po che'i, "jewel."
• In "amazement had arisen," yang mtshan is read as ya mtshan, "amazement," the word the root text uses just after. The particle glossed as "singling him out from his companions" is spelled kyi; it is taken here as the vocative "O" (kye), which that gloss suits, though it could be the genitive "of." Zla ba bde mchog is rendered "Moon Saṃvara" following the house rendering of bde mchog; it may instead mean "the moon, supreme bliss." "The rain" renders char, whose reference here is unclear (perhaps the rain of flowers described above). "Bird-face" (bya gdong) translates a term of yogic anatomy literally; its Sanskrit equivalent could not be identified. In the lemma "by place and by measure," sa is taken as "place."
• Rigs drug here is the six buddha families headed by Vairocana, not the six classes of beings.

The six items "the rain, the drop, the mode, the mere mode, the supreme, and the other supreme," which the text calls the six unions, are translated literally; char yang ("the rain") could not be identified. Zla mo is taken as "companion"; it could also be read as "moon lady." So sho mna' is read as a Tibetan transcription of suṣumṇā, the name of the central channel. Chad pa'i dga' ba is the third of the four joys, "the joy of cessation," not "annihilation." "The tongue" (lce ma) may stand for the channel rasanā. Lang tshos ra pa is read as lang tsho shar ba, "in the bloom of youth."

• "Jewel" and "buddha" are here the cover terms for the two vessels of the union, the jewel standing for means and the "precious buddha" for wisdom; they are translated literally. "From below the hub of means" reads lte ba ("hub") for lta ba ("view"), and "upper limit" reads steng for stong; "the four beginning with 'the joy of desire'" reads bzhis for bzhin, as in the parallel sentences. "Rains" (char yang), as in the preceding piece, could not be identified, nor could the word uta. Chad pa'i dga' ba is the third joy, "the joy of cessation." "Daṇḍa periods" renders dbyu gu, a unit of time, distinct from the "staff" (dbyug pa) of life; "hours" renders chu tshod (nāḍikā).

• "Lightning" renders thog, which also means "top"; the commentary plays on this, saying that natural joy has come "on top of" all the joys. "Rain" (char yang, here spelled char yar) is rendered as in the earlier pieces; the term could not be identified. In "purifies conceptual thought," rtogs pa ("realization") is read as rtog pa ("conceptual thought"). "Cut off by the real" reads the genitive kyi as the instrumental kyis; as written, the sentence could mean that the phenomena of apprehended and apprehender obstruct the real. The sequel to the Subsequent Tantra (rgyud phyi ma'i phyi ma) and the Essence Tantra (snying po'i rgyud) are translated literally; they could not be identified with confidence.

• "Interrupted joy" renders chad pa'i dga' ba (also chad dga'), here a technical term for the joys that have a basis and attachment and so break off, set against intrinsic joy (rang bzhin dga' ba); the glossary sense "annihilation" does not fit this usage. Likewise rigs drug pa here is "the sixth family" (Vajrasattva's, beyond the five), not the six classes of beings. The gloss on "nectar" (bdud rtsi) as the elixir against the afflictions plays on its Tibetan etymology: the elixir (rtsi) against the māras (bdud).

"Intrinsic joy comes to be accomplished as something not found" renders 'grub pa ma rnyed par 'gyur, taken as non-apprehension in line with the verse quoted just before; it could also be read as saying that intrinsic joy is not yet found at that stage.

"The Discerner" renders rnam par 'byed pa, which can also mean one who opens, splits or divides; the commentary identifies it with bodhicitta and links it to the sixteen drops of bliss.

In the verse on the two truths the text reads khab ("needle"), which does not fit the instrumental construction; it is translated as the evident reading khyab, "pervaded." In "la sogs paṃ yang" the stray anusvāra is read as "pa."

The explanation "whatever is pure of all conceptual thought is called Brahmā" plays on the Tibetan name of Brahmā, tshangs pa, "the pure one." Brahmā, Viṣṇu, Rudra, Īśvara and Sadāśiva (rtag tu zhi ba) are the five Śaiva "causes," here identified with the five buddhas; "the diligent performance of deeds" (bya ba nan tan) evokes Amoghasiddhi's gnosis of accomplishing activities.

• "Drop of gnosis" renders ye shes thig le (jñānatilaka), which is also the name of the deity and tantra, glorious Jñānatilaka; the commentary takes it as intrinsic joy, the sixteenth drop.

In "from this comes interrupted joy," the text reads chud pa'i dga' ba; it is taken as a slip for chad pa'i dga' ba, the term used throughout for this joy.

The gloss of "Its end is known to be in the bhaga" as the Blessed One plays on bhagavat, "possessor of the bhaga"; the bhaga, the female organ, is here that of wisdom, the consort.

"Although that had been given" renders byin yang as it stands; it may instead be a slip for a word meaning "again."

The verse on the channels abbreviates iḍā and piṅgalā for the meter. The channel name "Secret" (gsang ba) is translated literally, since its Sanskrit form is not certain.
The second colophon gives the title as "Lamp of Intrinsic Joy" (rang bzhin dga' ba'i sgron ma), where the first has "Lamp of Innate Joy" (lhan cig skyes pa'i dga' ba'i sgron ma); both render the same Sanskrit title.
• Several items in the verse list of bodily constituents are obscure (mig rdu, gnyer ma, lto kha spu, sha ma). A khri, not a known word, is read as bile (mkhris pa), which such lists normally include; rdul is taken in its tantric sense of menses (rajas). Bones and blood do occur twice in the Tibetan.
Chad pa'i dga' ba is rendered "the joy of cessation" (viramānanda), one of the four joys; the doctrinal sense "annihilation" does not apply here.
Lha yi dbang phyug, kept as "the Īśvara of the gods" for consistency with the earlier rendering of dbang phyug, is here a title ("lord of the gods") for the one who confers the empowerment, not the Hindu god.
• Khakhvamukha and bola are secret-language terms left in Sanskrit; bola normally denotes the male organ, and khakhvamukha is evidently its female counterpart.
Si la ga phur is read as storax (silhaka) and camphor, here names for the bodhicitta.
In "the bodhicitta and the sun" (byang chub kyi sems nyi ma) the sun is taken as the red element paired with the white bodhicitta; the phrase is terse.
The four sites of the elements are given as written (secret place, navel, emanation cakra, heart), although the emanation cakra is usually placed at the navel.
• The Tibetan rigs drug here means the six buddha families, which the six seals (the bone ornaments beginning with the wheel) embody, not the six classes of beings. The charnel grounds Terrible and Repulsive could not be identified with standard Sanskrit names, so their names are translated; likewise "the ḍākinī of delusion" is translated from the Tibetan. What "the fourth" left aside at the center of the eight-petaled lotus refers to is unclear, and it is rendered literally. In the verse on the word mantra, the expression rendered "solace" (dbugs 'byung ba) can also mean "out-breath." The enjoyment wheel and the great bliss wheel are the throat and crown cakras, with sixteen and thirty-two channels; the word "wheel" is supplied, as the Tibetan says only "of enjoyment" and "of great bliss."
• The opening gloss reads literally "the absence of any pervading of all things by intrinsic joy"; it may be meant apophatically, like the list that follows, or a negative may have dropped out ("there is nothing intrinsic joy does not pervade"); it is translated as written. In "likewise for ca and the rest" the written rtsa is read as the letter ca, an evident copyist's slip. The sentence "After that come the pure ones" is obscure in the Tibetan. In this passage the Tibetan i is the vowel letter, not the channel iḍā, and sems kyi dbang phyug is "the lord of mind," an epithet of the syllable, not the god Īśvara.
• The Tibetan gu gu is read as gi gu, the vowel sign i. The phrase rendered "for Stainless Sky and Candragarbha" could also be read as "the heart mantra of Stainless Sky and the Moon." The names Surpassing Prowess, Lady of the Left, Born Lady, Fearsome Lady, Radiant Lady, and Well-Pleased Lady could not be identified with Sanskrit names and are translated. "The marvelous" is glossed with dri, literally "scent," taken here as excrement, which completes the five nectars. In "great lord of yogins," said of Indrabhūti, dbang phyug chen po is an epithet, not Maheśvara (Śiva).
• In the gloss on "By days, letters, and mantras," the commentary writes chos ("dharma") where the lemma has tshes ("days"); it is read as "days," an evident copyist's slip. Here drag po is the fierce rite, one of the four rites, not Rudra. In the verse on minds "devoured by spirits" ('byung po), the commentator plays on 'byung, "to flow out," taking it as the bodhicitta flowing away.

• In "the vajra thread" the root text reads skul ("urge"); the commentary's "thread of five colors" shows that skud ("thread") is meant. Among the limbs of the maṇḍala, rgyal is read as rgyan, "ornaments." "Storax" takes si la as sihla, a fragrant resin.
• In the explanation of the request, zhes dang gus pa'i tshul is read as zhe sa dang gus pa'i tshul, "with courtesy and respect." The root's sar pa sprin is read as gsar pa sprin, "a fresh cloud," the stock image of a dark rain cloud. The root line on maṃ and hūṃ (thig tshul grangs) is terse; it is rendered following the commentary's pairing of maṃ with the form and hūṃ with the drop, and grangs ("are reckoned") is uncertain. The lines on "Brahmā's domain" and "Brahmā's two hands" are obscure, perhaps coded language, and are rendered literally; the commentary glosses them only by the deities' features. Rigs drug, usually "the six classes of beings," here names the six families with which the six bone ornaments (the six seals) are identified. Dor stabs, rendered "paired stance" (dor, "a pair," for the four legs), is uncertain and may be a slip for rdor stabs, "vajra stance." Yama in the east presumably stands for the wrathful Yamāntaka; shes rab mthar phyin is taken as Prajñāntaka, with mthar phyin rendering -antaka.
• Dharmataya is read as dharmodaya, the triangular source of phenomena arising from e. Sprul gyi rgyan is read as sbrul gyi rgyan, ornaments of snakes. In dbu skra ser ba, ser ba is the color tawny, not hail. Sum rgyal is taken as Sumbharāja, the wrathful one of the nadir, placed in the west, as Uṣṇīṣacakravartin of the zenith is placed in the east; it could also abbreviate Trailokyavijaya. The phrase drang srong la sogs mtshams su places the four preceding wrathful ones in the intermediate directions starting from that of the sage, perhaps the southeast of Agni; this is uncertain. In Mahābala's emblems, dud zhags is taken as a noose; dud is unclear. The tree list is obscure: dpal gyi me tog (glorious flower) and mig rdzi (eye-keeper) are unidentified and rendered literally, va and ngang are left as written, and nine items appear where eight are counted. Nyi ma 'jigs, the sun-fearer, is taken as the owl, after the Sanskrit divābhīta, afraid of the day. Rde'u chung, small pebble, among Jñānatilaka's emblems is unclear. The heroes' names are rendered by meaning, as in earlier pieces.
• Many heroine and site names here cannot be identified with confidence and are rendered by meaning, as in earlier pieces. Byi la, cat, names a class of sacred site alongside the sites, fields, gathering places and charnel grounds, perhaps rendering Sanskrit pīlava. The one-faced, two-armed figures holding lotus vessel and curved knife, whose ornaments accord with the fathers', are called dpa' bo, heroes, in the text; this is read as dpa' mo, heroines. Rigs drug here is the six families with which the six seals are identified, not the six classes of beings. Ko sgo, rendered hide door, is an unidentified body site. Gser zhogs is rendered gold, dawn; it may be a slip for gser zhun, refined gold. Rlag, rendered destruction, is uncertain.
• In the list of the ladies' places, pa yi tshig is read as ba yi mig, a cow's eye, matching the City of Youths to the cow's eye of the heroes' list, whose order the second list reverses. Rtswa'i shing, trees of grass, is read as rtsa'i shing, trees of the channels, since the eight ladies named are the channels earlier called trees. Yan lag ma, literally limb ladies, is taken as rendering Sanskrit aṅganā, women, here the heroines. Several place names are spelled differently from the earlier lists (Sridka for Siṅga, Mumu for Maru, Dekauṭa for Devīkoṭī, Koluta for Kauluta and for Kuluta, Harikol for Halikali, Gautaba for Kutapa, Karnuja for Karuja, Karata for Ketara, Karmira for Kashmir, Cinta for Cindaro); they are given as spelled here. The phrase mchog dang chad pa, between the supreme and annihilation, is obscure.
• Chad pa here, as in chad pa'i dga', is cessation, the joy of cessation (viramānanda), not annihilation; mchog dang chad pa are the supreme joy and the joy of cessation, between which intrinsic joy is placed, which also explains the previous piece's "between the supreme and annihilation." The verse on killing all living creatures is the tantras' coded language, which the text itself glosses as halting all migration; in this literature it refers to stopping the movement

of the vital winds, not to literal killing. Rlung ma and gnyid ma, the Wind Lady and the Sleep Lady, are unclear. In the prose, rtsi'i mdud pa is read as rtsa'i mdud pa, the knot of the channel. For ḍa, "appearance, the attainment of appearance" presumably stands for the third appearance, near-attainment.

• In the verse on wind, phyi ru ("outside") is read as phyir ("because"), which the sense requires. In the list of the four joys, chad pa'i dga' ba is rendered "the joy of cessation" (viramānanda), not "annihilation." The Glorious Flower of Joy (dpal dga' ba'i me tog), to which the reader is referred for the oblation, appears to be a work by title; it is not identified, and its name is translated. Bola and kakkola are the tantric code words for the male and female organs.

• The line “one should recite by one's own light, uncontrived” is read as “own light” followed by the negative “uncontrived,” which the commentary glosses as not depending on conditions; the syllables here are not taken as the name the Radiant Lady.

Rasanā, elsewhere the right channel, is explained here by the commentary as the tongue, the ordinary sense of the Sanskrit word.

In “free from wisdom (prajñā)” after the mention of the action seal, wisdom refers, as often in the tantras, to the female partner of the union practice; the commentator's own explanation is that recitation here does not depend on such a partner.

Sihla, a fragrant resin, and camphor are code words of the tantras' intentional language for the female and male generative fluids.

The triad dissolution, enjoyment and power is correlated by the commentary with the three bodies; power here is not the empowerment of initiation.

“The two, method and wisdom” renders a phrase that literally reads “wisdom from method.”

The buffalo simile and the remark about the great master are rendered literally; the text does not explain them further.

• Manifest joy stands here, in the reversed sequence, in the second place, where supreme joy stands elsewhere in the text.

Outer renders a word that can also mean later.

In the sentence on the conduct tantra, the closing word as printed means request; it is read as the similar-looking word meaning clear, matching the verse.

In “the name ‘higher yoga’” the word for name is the honorific one, as the commentary's gloss shows, not the word for a major mark.

The Bird-Faced One, said to be at the center of the three channels, is translated literally because its Sanskrit form cannot be identified with confidence.

• Variety, maturation, destruction and freedom from characteristics are the four moments of the tantric scheme (vicitra, vipāka, vimarda, vilakṣaṇa), here matched to the empowerments and the joys.

The bodhisattva called Lord of the Gods, and the twice-born channel, are translated literally because their Sanskrit forms cannot be identified with confidence.

“In terms of” follows the evident reading of a word printed with a similar-looking syllable meaning blue.

In the second verse on the empowerment “done for your sake,” the printed text has “and” where the first verse and the commentary have “meaning”; the evident reading “meaning” is translated.

• The word rendered “taste” in “the taste of bliss that is dead and free of breath” also means “corpse,” a play suited to the charnel ground.

The lotus vessel is, in the code language of the tantras, the skull cup.

“Considering” and “to cut through doubt” follow the evident readings of two words printed with similar-looking or similar-sounding syllables, which as printed would mean “actually” and “offering doubt.”

• “Twilight” in the verse follows the commentary, which explains night, day and twilight; the verse as printed has a similar-looking word meaning “mark” in that place.
• A few spellings are read as evident slips: a wa ngha dhū tī as avadhūtī, i dang as ida followed by "and", and char yang in the description of the Great Seal as can yang, "having the nature of". Sila (si la) is left untranslated: it appears to be a coded name for the substance that rasanā causes to enter, set beside urine for lalanā and camphor, that is bodhicitta, for avadhūtī; elsewhere rasanā is said to carry blood. Among the goddess's questions, "grass" (rtswa) is translated as written, though the reply, which concerns the channels (rtsa), suggests it may be a slip for "channels". The gloss on "nectar" plays on the Tibetan word bdud rtsi, read as the elixir (rtsi) against māra (bdud).
• The root line rendered "Then it contracts, and that is the sign" reads literally "then that, the sign, kum"; kum is taken as the verb "to contract, draw in", in keeping with the commentary's account of the winds ceasing, but the reading is uncertain. In the verse, "the broad joint" and "the golden circle" render obscure terms (□□□□□□□□□□, □□□□□□□□□□) that may be names of inner sacred sites; they are translated literally. In the phrase "burns up thoughts, signs, and all the wheels", the text writes realization (□□□□□□□) where thought (□□□□□□) is plainly meant. In the gloss on "Brahmā's domain", the obscure word □□□ (possibly the lalanā channel) before "center of the wheel of emanation" is left untranslated.
• Half-numbers are read in the Tibetan idiom the commentary itself spells out: "half of twelve" is six, "half of six" is three, "half of half of sixteen" is four. The quoted phrase beginning "and also the rain" and the list "the rain, the manner of the drop, the mere manner, the supreme and the other supreme, the six, and the white mustard" seem to be cryptic designations tying the syllables of Śrījñānatilaka to the six yogas; they are rendered literally, and their exact correspondence is uncertain. The left channel is called "sahi" untranslated, in parallel with musk for lalanā and camphor for sośomna; it may be a substance such as storax (si hla), but this is uncertain. "The bird-face" renders an unidentified location in the subtle body. In "abides in bliss, in the lalanā" the syntax of the Tibetan is unclear. Maheśvara here is an epithet of Jñānatilaka, not of Śiva.
• In the verse, the tenth line repeats "near-assembly" where the sequence calls for the near-charnel ground; it is translated as written. Several ground names are spelled irregularly and are rendered as they stand: "Good Intelligence" (sādhumatī, written with a syllable meaning "attached"), "Coming Everywhere" (probably for Universal Light, samantaprabhā), and the joy "ut", left as written. The phrase rendered "joy of cessation" in the chapter twenty commentary is written "joy of heat" (tshad pa for chad pa), an evident slip. "The secret tip" renders an obscure expression (gsang sna).
• The short passage beginning "Now, in the four spheres there is the formless realm" is elliptical; it is taken as the setting of an objection (that mind exists without a body in the formless spheres), answered by the statement that the teaching addresses beings of the desire realm.
• The author's name, given in Tibetan translation, is rendered Vajraguhya. The word rendered "summary" in the closing verses could also be read as "vow"; "summary" follows the preceding remark that the teaching is condensed here.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.